

Nikola Stoyanov

portfolio 2021-2026

Curriculum Vitae

Nikola Stoyanov (1994, Varna) is a visual artist and independent researcher living in Sofia, Bulgaria. He works in the intersection of research based and speculative practices in both the artistic and academic fields. He has authored numerous exhibitions on topics ranging from geo-philosophy and techno-paranoia to most recently post-soviet conspiratorial thought and the geopolitics of folk-philosophy.

In his practice he is heavily inspired by the brute idea of photography as a manner of seeing the world. Visually his work borrows techniques of scientific and technological abstraction interweaving the humanities with the technology.

Stoyanov is a leading author and translator of philosophy and theory in several niches of contemporary thought such as theory fiction, hauntology and accelerationism. He is classically educated in philosophy and history of technology in the United Kingdom.

SOLO/DUO EXHIBITIONS ↓

- 2024 - [Postcards and Contraband](#)
- 2023 - [Nature Morte](#)
- 2023 - [Postcards and Contraband](#)
- 2022 - [Latent Space](#)
- 2022 - [Re:Process↗](#)
- 2021 - [I-Ixa↗](#)
- 2021 - [In:Process↗](#)

GROUP PROJECTS & EXHIBITIONS ↓

- 2025 - [Petro-Drift↗](#)
- 2025 - Even trolls sleep sometimes
- 2024 - The Last Good Party
- 2024 - [Black Fax off the Hook](#)
- 2024 - [You'll Understand When the Time Comes↗](#)
- 2023 - Exemplary Home
- 2023 - Death Valley
- 2023 - The World After / Post-apocalyptic Notes
- 2022 - [Humour is the politeness of despair↗](#)
- 2022 - [Grey Zone/Dispositive↗](#)
- 2022 - The Big MONUMENT of the Small Past
- 2021 - Allegorical Impulse
- 2021 - Yet Another Exponat

PUBLICATIONS ↓

2026 - Complicity in Death: The Necro-Genre in the Fourth Part of 2666[↗]
Critical essay in issue 3 (2026) of “Literature Newspaper” | ISSN 1310-9561 (BG)

2025 - Theoretical Fictions and Hyperstition: A Rough Introduction[↗]
Article in “Studia Litteraria Serdicensia” (BAS Journal) Sofia (BG)

2025 - Last Drag[↗]
Critical essay in the “Atelier” column of the Cultural Center of Sofia University “St. Kliment Ohridski”(BG)

2024 - On the Border of Life[↗]
Article in “BORDERS” Simulacrum Magazine Amsterdam (NL)

2023 - Postcards and Contraband (book)[↗]
Published by H. Kaloyanov | ISBN: 978-619-92510-1-0

2023 - Nature Morte (book)[↗]
Published by H. Kaloyanov | ISBN: 978-619-92510-0-3

2023 - Places of Ecological History[↗]
In “Journal for Social Vision” | Sofia (BG)

2022 - The Ontological Status of Generative Art[↗]
In “Derzine” Magazine | Sofia (BG)

2023 - In:Process (book)[↗]
Published by H. Kaloyanov | ISBN: 978-619-188-514-5

LECTURES AND TALKS ↓

2025 - Nets and Webs: Hypertextual Strategies and Infrastructure in Writing[↗]
Lecture at a conference of the Bulgarian Academy of Sciences (Nov 6, 2025), outlining a shift from indexed note systems to networked and algorithmic writing infrastructures, to contemporary attention-driven feeds.

2024 - On the trail of a trivial insight[↗]
Discussion accompanying the exhibition Postcards and Contraband, Charta Gallery 21 April 2024 with the participation of Raina Markova and Hristo Kaloyanov

2024 - Paranoid Semiotics[↗]
Talk given at “The Evident” conference, hosted by Culture Centre “St. Kliment Ohridski” University

2024 - Theoretical fictions and para-literature[↗]
Talk given at “Genres in Paraliterature” conference, hosted by Literature Theory departments “St. Kliment Ohridski” University and Bulgarian Science Association

2021 - Accelarationism Today[↗]
Talk given at book presentation for Mark Fisher’s “Capitalist Realism” hosted by “KOI” books publishing.

TRANSLATIONS (selection) ↓

2025 | Time, Memory and Inner Space[↗] | J. G. Ballard in “Literature Newspaper”, ISSN 1310-9561

2024 | What I believe[↗] | J.G. Ballard translation for “New Asocial Poetry”

2022 | Having a blast[↗] | J. G. Ballard

2022 | Cyberpositive[↗] | Nick Land, Sadie Plant

2021 | A short history of Geotrauma[↗] | R. Mackay

2021 | The Minnesota Declaration[↗] | Werner Herzog

2021 | Knots[↗] | R. D. Laing translation for “New Asocial Poetry”

2021 | Killing the Love[↗] | Anne Sexton translation for “New Social Poetry”

2020 | The Xenofeminist Manifesto[↗] | Labboria Cubonics

2020 | Corona Demonology | Jason Mohaghegh

INTERVIEWS AND MEDIA COVERAGE (selection) ↓

2026 - Elle Magazine[↗]
2025 - Panorama[↗]
2025 - Interview in Programata[↗]
2025 - Boyscout Magazine[↗]
2024 - The Day with V. Dremdzhiev[↗]
2024 - Bulgarian National Television[↗]
2024 - Art Viewer[↗]
2024 - Euronews TV[↗]
2024 - Radio Program Horizont[↗]
2023 - Bulgarian Telegraph Agency[↗]
2023 - Bulgarian National Television[↗]
2023 - Darik Radio[↗]
2023 - Bulgarian National Radio[↗]
2022 - Bulgarian National Radio[↗]

RESIDENCIES ↓

2021 - Allegorical Impulse | Rumman Collective, Amman (JO)

EDUCATION ↓

2021 - Teachers Degree | DIKPO , Varna (BG)

2016 - Philosophy and Sociology | University of Sussex, Brighton (UK) | BA Hons

2013 - Computer Science | Technical High School, St. Clement of Ohridski, Varna (BG)

2012 - Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency in English | British Council | CPE, Sofia (BG)

ORGANISATIONS ↓

2026 - Bulgarian Union of Arists
Became a member of “Section 13” of the Bulgarian Union of Artists.

2024 - Temporary Space
Founding member of “Temporary Space” foundation and publishing house[↗].

OTHER WORK ↓

2025-26 - XX-63 (TREVOGA)
Wrote dramaturgy and produced XX-63[↗] perfomance with TREGOVA collective. currently on european tour[↗].

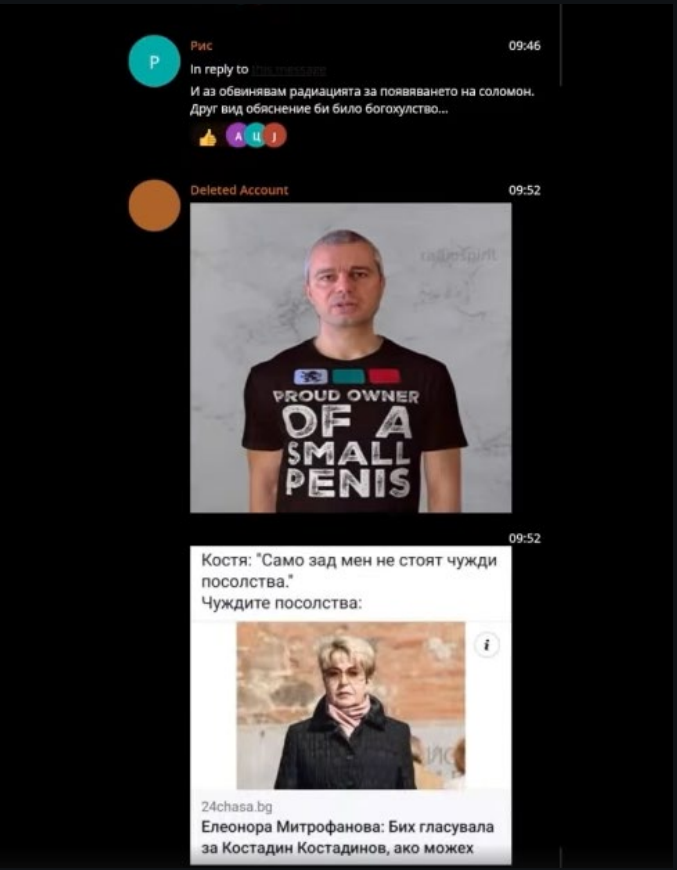
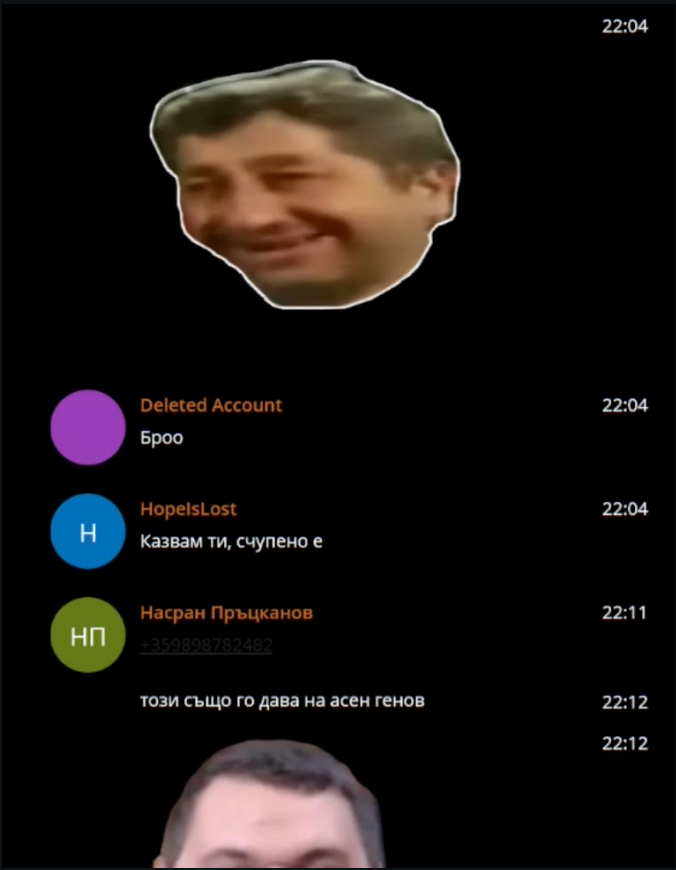
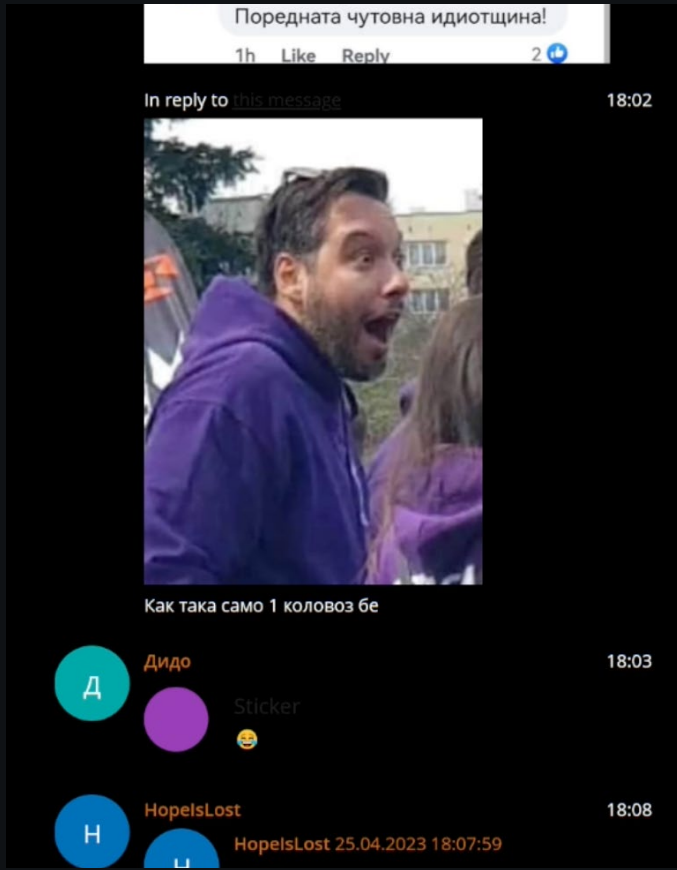
2024 - Technical artist
Custom code and 3D print work for Aksian Peycheva’s exhibition “LOOK – Ecology and Technology”[↗]

2024 - Technical artist
Video work for Hristo Kaloyanov in exhibition “Last Good Party”

2022 - Visual identity for craft beer company “Euphoria Brew”[↗]

Even trolls sleep sometimes

as part of „Her poisonous doubles: Watch Your Feed!”
at Goethe-Institut (Sofia, BG)
25.03-30.04.2025



Even trolls sleep sometimes

curated by Philip Stoilov and Sofia Grancharova

Troll
noun (in folklore): an ugly creature depicted as a giant or dwarf.
verb (fishing): a fisherman luring fish by pulling bait behind a boat in motion.
verb (on the internet): to provoke (other) people online by deliberately posting inflammatory, inappropriate or offensive comments or other disruptive content.

Although the origin of these creatures comes from ancient lore, the modern root of the online slang “trolling” was borrowed from a technique in fishing, which itself was later borrowed by military pilots during the Korean War. The type of operations where “trolling” of MiGs was applied as a tactic to lure the enemy into responding to false targets. Here the pilots play the role of “decoy,” hoping the attackers will take the bait and reveal themselves.

“Even trolls sleep sometimes” is an art piece consisting of over 288:05:65 hours of chat archives from the Russian Troll Foundation online community Telegram channel. This period captures a time when personal information from a coordinated attack on the author (doxing) was actively being spread, possibly based on a leak from the GP system. Thus, “human flesh search engines” (人肉搜索) were mobilized to seek out and divulge personal data in order to accumulate coercive dependence through fear and intimidation. In this community, much like the KGB tradition of collecting and disseminating kompromats, threats, and gaining credibility through fear, mutual provocations reign as the engine of communication and “brotherhood.” But not through propaganda information that confirms a given point of view, but rather by setting camouflaged targets in front of people who have been actively riled up.

The piece was originally conceived as “art in the form of provocation” and was meant to be just that, a live provocation to a given group. This turned out to be impossible, as the group itself had already been emptied.

“Even trolls sleep sometimes” is a meditation not only on targeted attacks on individuals, but - more importantly - on the function of online networks and hate bubbles, borrowing techniques from the shadowy operations of multiple secret services of the recent past. In his own eyes the troll is a trickster playing to a nameless audience on the web, and the product of his activity are always discord.

The artwork was part of the exhibition „Her poisonous doubles: Watch Your Feed!” at Goethe-Institut in collaboration with Lexi Fleur, Slava George, Yanitsa Fendulova, Marina Genova, Nikola Andreev, Nikola Tsvetanov and Kiril Bukhovski.

Accompanying Events↓

[Discussion „The Truth and Its Poisonous Doubles”](#)[↗]
14.04.2025
Goethe-Institut, Bulgaria

Critique↓

[Terror as a Postmodern Game](#)
[Dimitar Vatsov](#)[↗]

Review essay on Russian propaganda and two art exhibitions in the NATO Strategic Communications Centre of Excellence Journal.

[On Quiet Art in Turbulent Times](#)
[Gergana Minkova](#)[↗]

Article in Portal Kultura that discusses the exhibition among other contemporary practices.

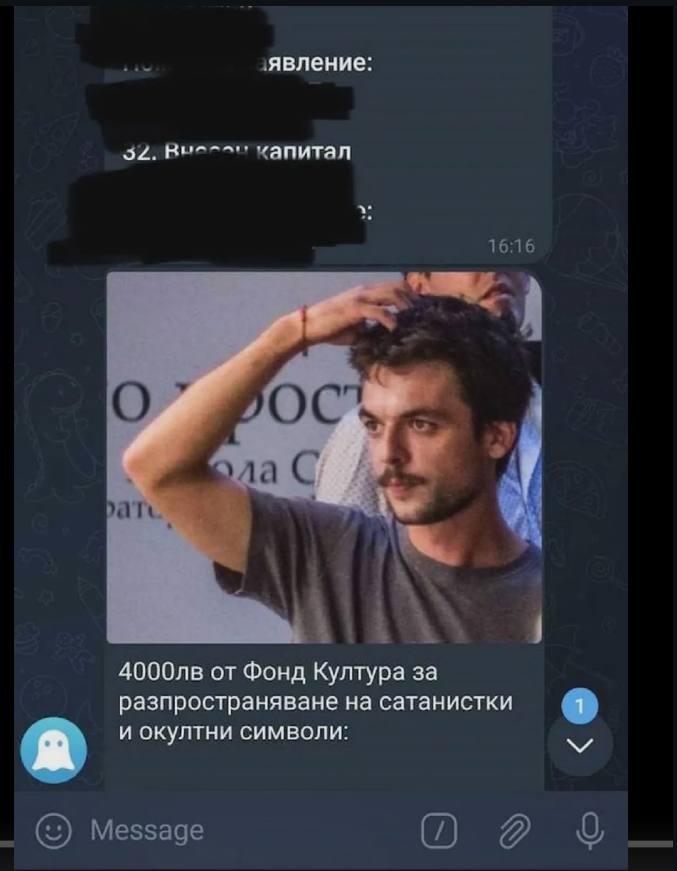
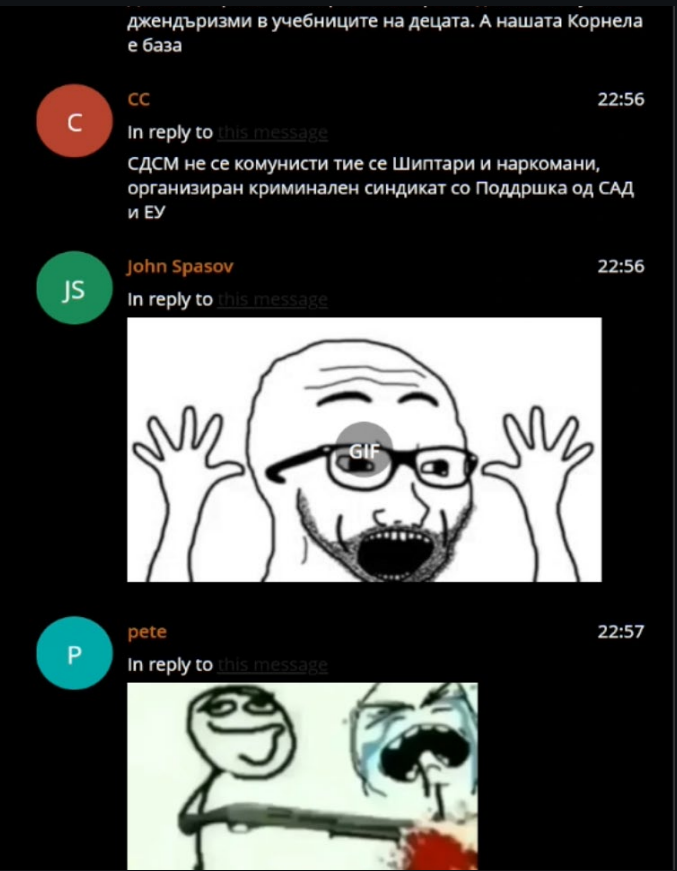
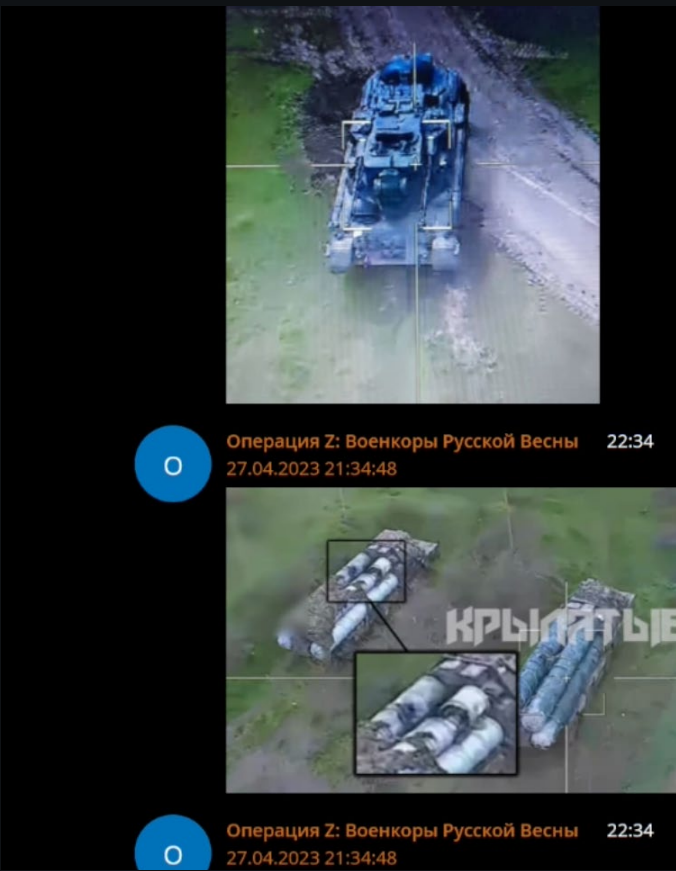
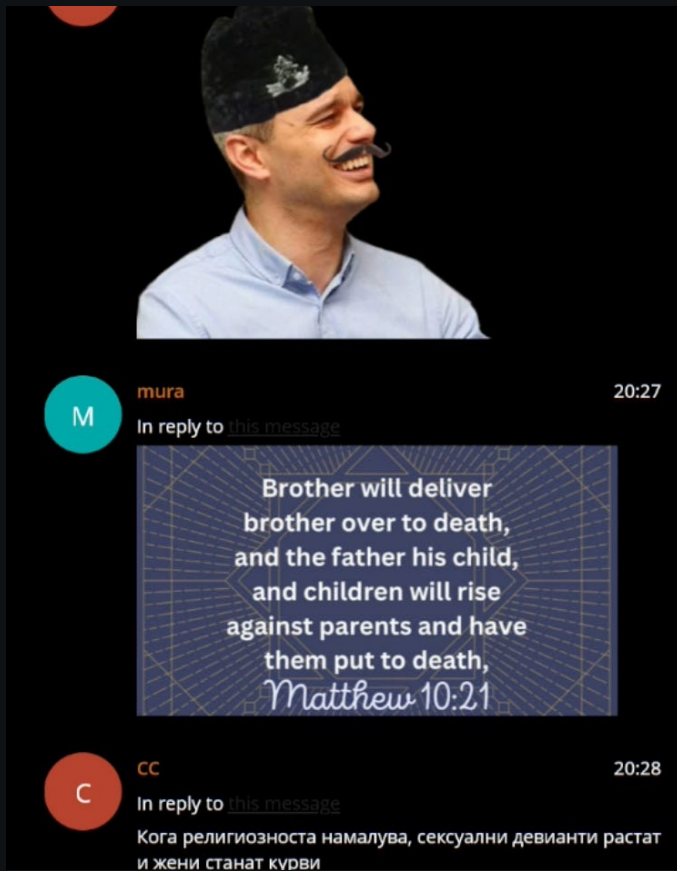
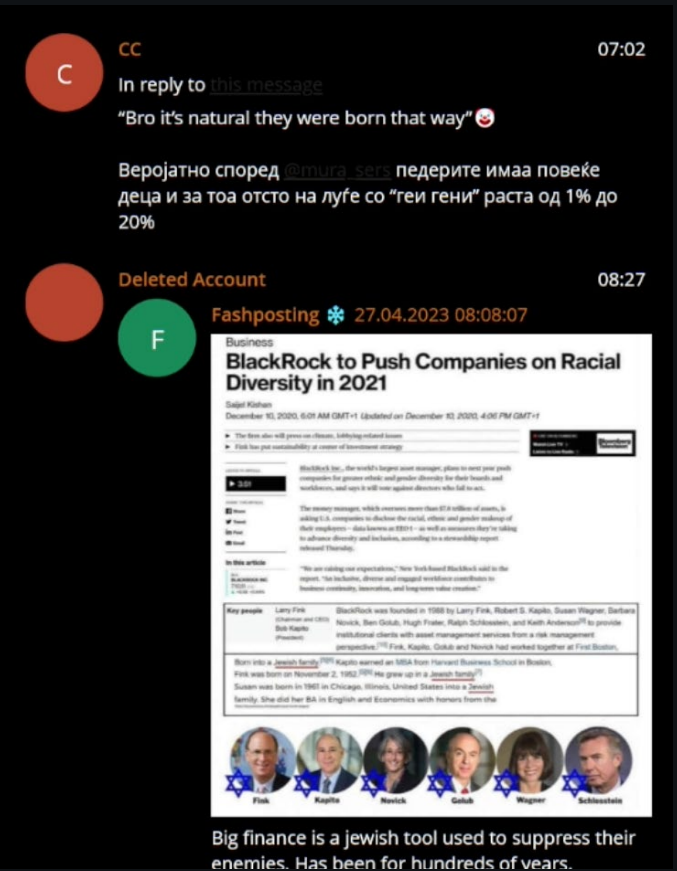
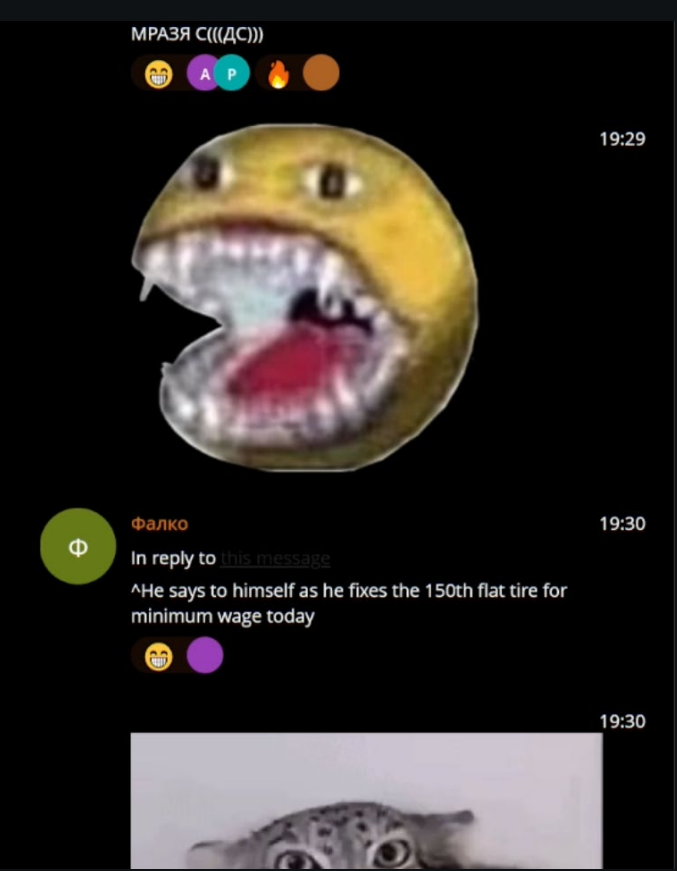
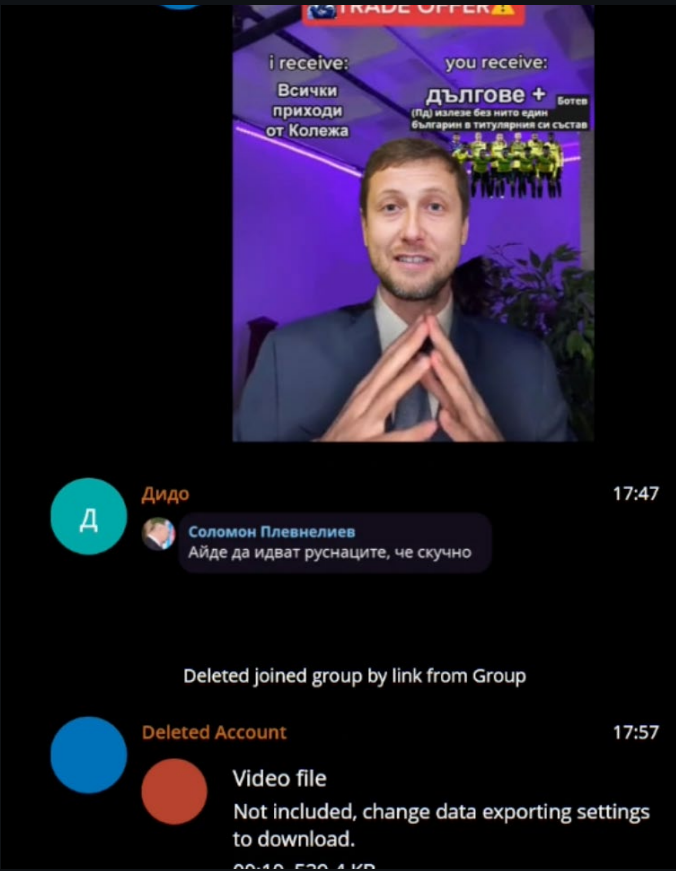
Press and Media↓

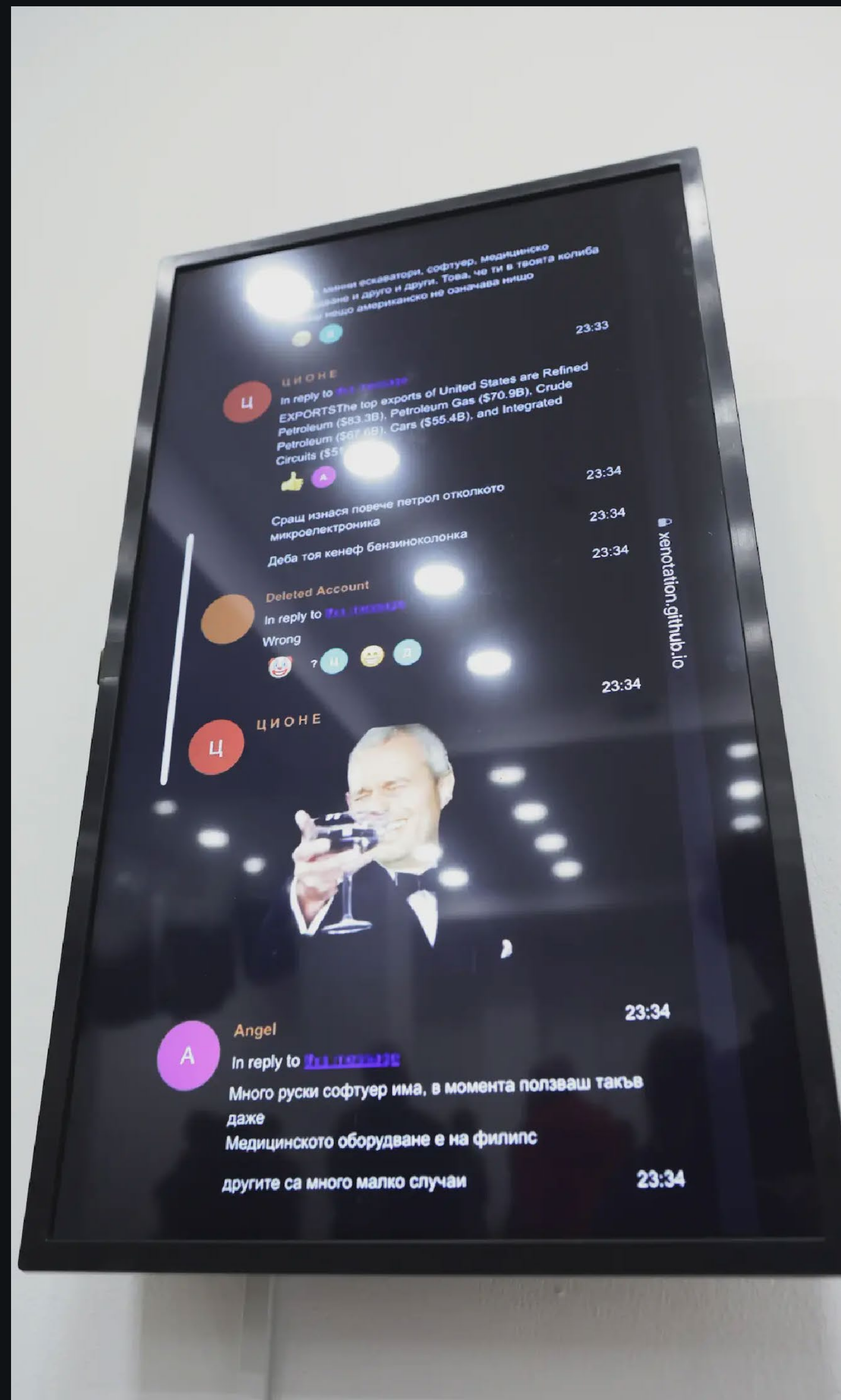
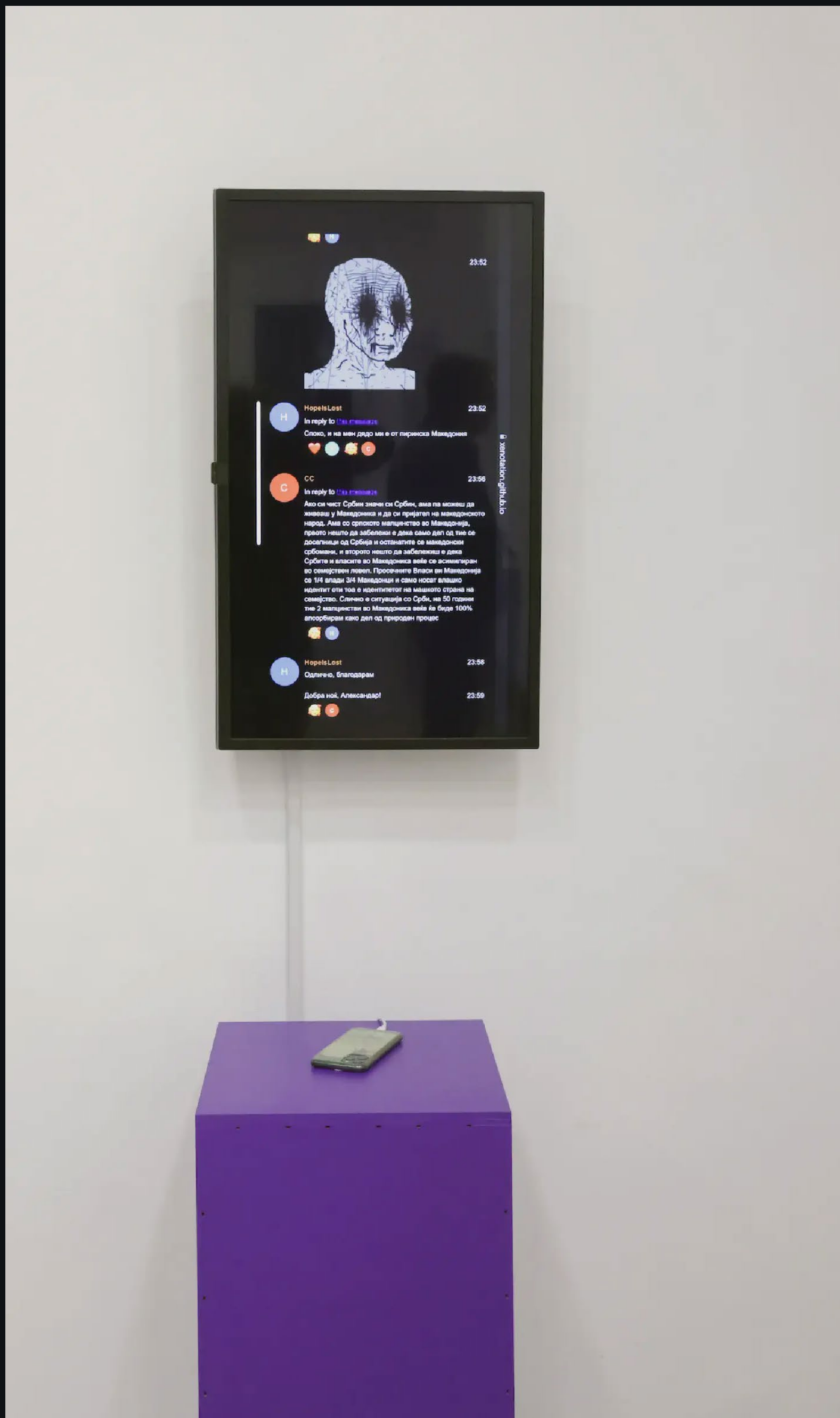
[Bulgarian National Radio – Hristo Botev](#)[↗]
[Kultura.BG](#)[↗]
[Panorama](#)[↗]
[The Day with V. Dremdzhev](#)[↗]
[Army Media](#)[↗]
[Bulgarian National Radio](#)[↗]
[Capital](#)[↗]
[Bulgarian National Television Programata](#)[↗]
[Telegraph](#)[↗]
[Bulgarian National Radio](#)[↗]
[Visible and Invisible](#)[↗]

Images to the right:

Video still of artist personal information being leaked to a pro-Russian, far-right chat group.

The caption reads “4000 leva from the National Culture Fund for the dissemination of satanic and occult symbols.”





The installation consisted of an 70x50cm (28x20 in.) LED TV streaming the display of the authors iPhone 11, on which screen plays a live website cloning the telegram chat application and displaying the entirety of the chats history including the leaking of the authors personal information on the 25th of February 2025. All chats are in real-time, some of the images have been sanitizes.

The chats vary from right-wing and pro-russian propaganda, to cheerful banter, through violence filled front-line war videos. In the artwork we can see this normally private group in public. How its echochamber functions.

Left:
LED TV
70x50x5 cm. / 28x20x2 in.

Center:
LED TV
70x50cmx5cm / 28x20x2 in.

Right:
Artists iPhone 11, with display duplicator,
Custom built Telegram clone website

Black fax off the hook

as part of SPorno festival 'THE DEVIANTS'
at Doza Gallery (Sofia, BG)
28.05-01.06.2024



Black fax off the hook

curated by Michaela Lakova and Voin De Voin

“Black Fax off the Hook” (т. Черен факс от ченге) is a cultural guerrilla operation leveraging the destructive power of spam. In its most basic sense, a black fax is a malicious transmission: a sheet of black print sent in rapid succession to a fax machine, overwhelming its ink and paper supply—a material assault akin to a digital denial-of-service attack.

The exhibit configures black faxing as a critique of media saturation, where information becomes a relentless assault on cognitive bandwidth, paralyzing its audience into psychic immobilization. It transforms into a weaponized inversion of Bulgarian mainstream media and political populist tactics, which wage a campaign of total info-saturation on the public consciousness.

The installation unfurls through 35 meters of gothic erotic fan fiction generated by the custom Bulgarian GPT developed by INSAIT (Institute for Computer Science, Artificial Intelligence and Technology) in collaboration with the Bulgarian government. “BgGPT,” engineered to understand Bulgarian language and culture, draws on an informational corpus potentially polluted with data from Bulgaria’s “yellow media”—scandal-driven, populist outlets serving sensationalism and political propaganda.

In this context, the AI creates grotesquely funny narratives, reanimating personalities like Boyko Borisov, Ivan Geshev, Konstantin Kostadinov, and Andrey Lukanov as protagonists of a dark, libidinal fiction of corruption and carnality—an obscene reimagining of political figures entwined in scandals that border on the mythological.

To “receive a fax” in Bulgarian idiom is to be struck by an intrusive idea. The slang term “ченге” (from Turkish, meaning “hook”) refers to a policeman or an agent of the former State Security Services (Д.С.) during the communist era—figures of enmeshed culpability and repressive continuity. The double translated title plays on this duplicity, with “off the hook” mirroring „от ченге” (literally “from a cop”), suggesting the tendency of such materials to be used as kompromats.

“Black Fax off the Hook” functions as a spam-apparatus in the form of a hacked Philips PPF631 Primo fax machine, mirroring the propaganda machine at the heart of contemporary populism. It challenges the idea of information as enlightenment, inviting viewers into an info-blitzkrieg where truth and fiction are continuously rewritten by forces vying for influence. Here, AI serves as a co-conspirator in a machinic production of scandal and spectacle.

The exhibit was featured as part of Bulgaria’s first porn festival, SPORNO—organized by Æther Sofia and Michaela Lakova in collaboration with Alexandar Yuzev, Patricio Ruiz, Anton Stoianov, Mitch Brezounek, Knives & Pepi, Biss Nova, Jeltje Schuurmans, Soul-pandemic, Sevda Semer, Voin de Voin 8 Ivana Nencheva, Svetli Evgeniev, Galina Dimitrova, Sofia Dimitrova, Corrine Fhima, Stephanie Telomere, Hrcprc.studio Pezieme, Georgi Pavlov, Kyril Buhowski.

Gallery view.



Hacked
Philips PPF631
Primo fax
machine with a
custom-made
timer device.

35 meters of
printed AI-generated
erotic fiction
featuring prominent
corrupt Bulgarian
politicians.



Postcards and Contraband

Charta Gallery, Posta Space (Sofia, BG)
11.04-12.05.2024

Re:Bonkers (Varna, BG)
07.09-21.09.2023

Postcards and Contraband

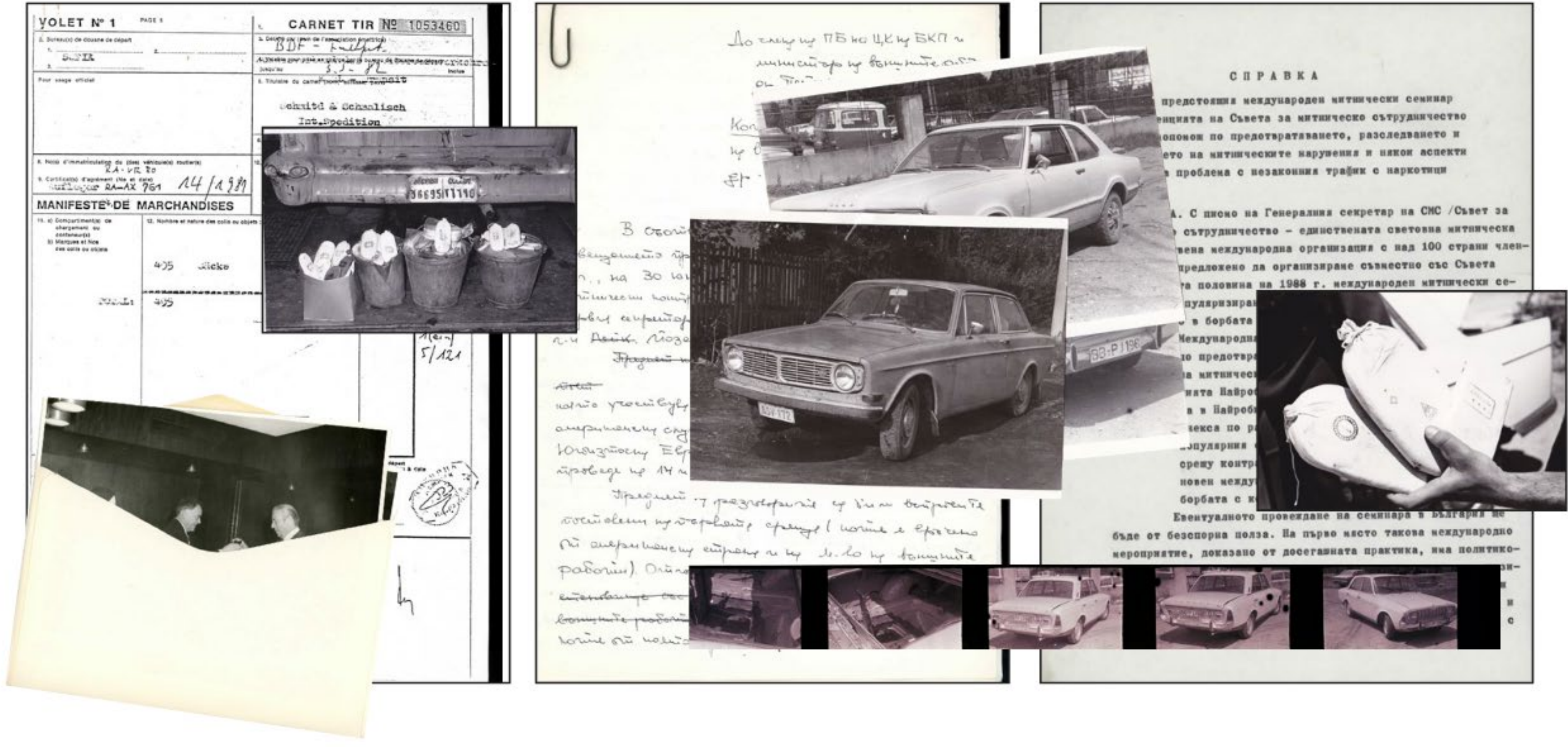
in collaboration with Aaron Roth

curated by Hristo Kaloyanov

“Postcards and Contraband” is an investigation on hidden trafficking and post-soviet conspiratorial thought. The present exhibition is an attempt at reading the transition period from communism to democracy in Bulgaria, through the figure of the border crossing. It is a child of archival fever basing itself on de-classified as well as found documents. To shed light into the underground of memory that is the hauntological process of what Bulgarians call transition. Tracing shady mob figures, hushed rumours and declassified documents, newspaper clippings and seminal assassination photographs it investigates the post-soviet conspiratorial line of thought as a instrument or technique of working though the trauma of unregulated lack of lustration after a transition from one political regime to another.

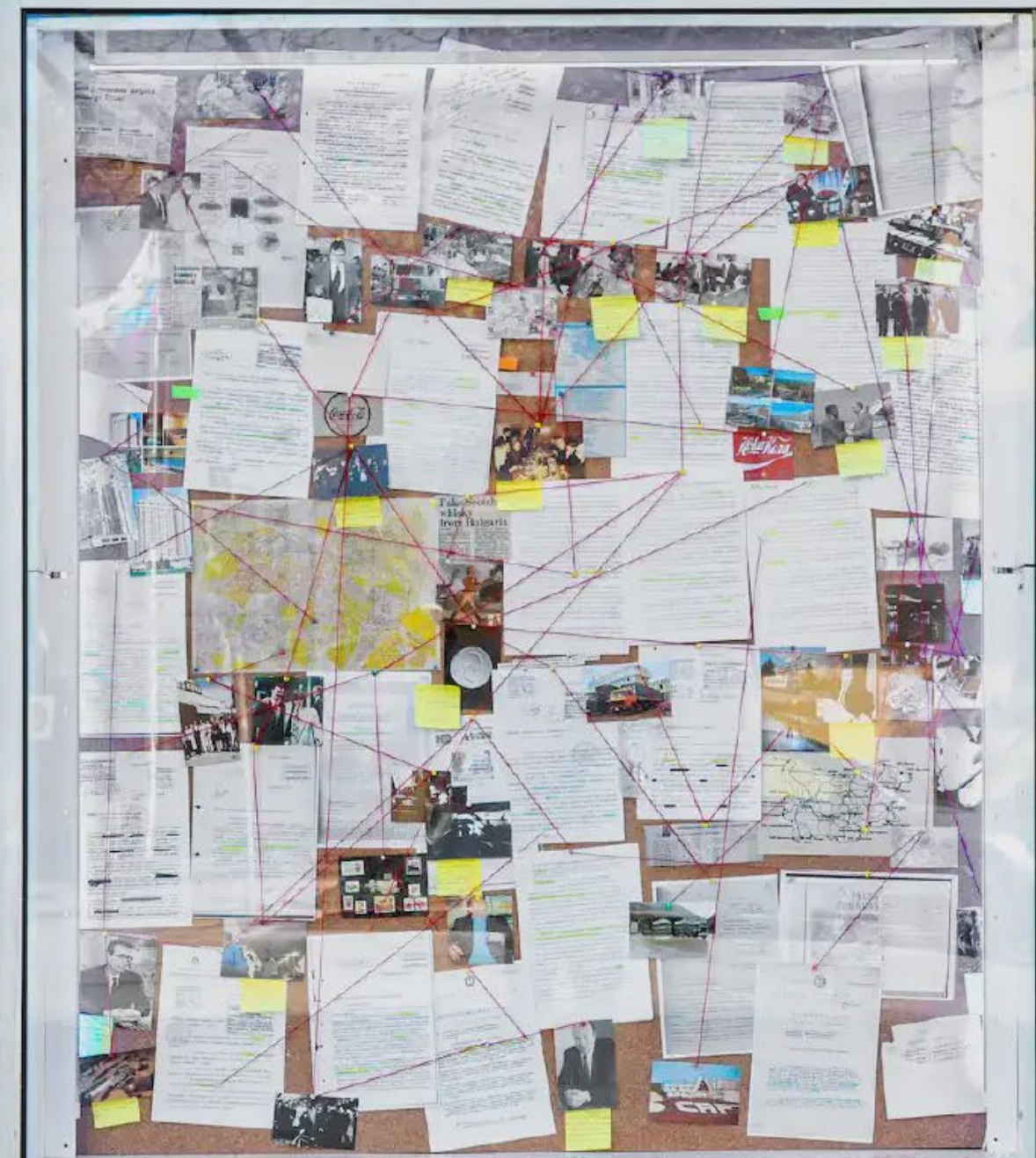
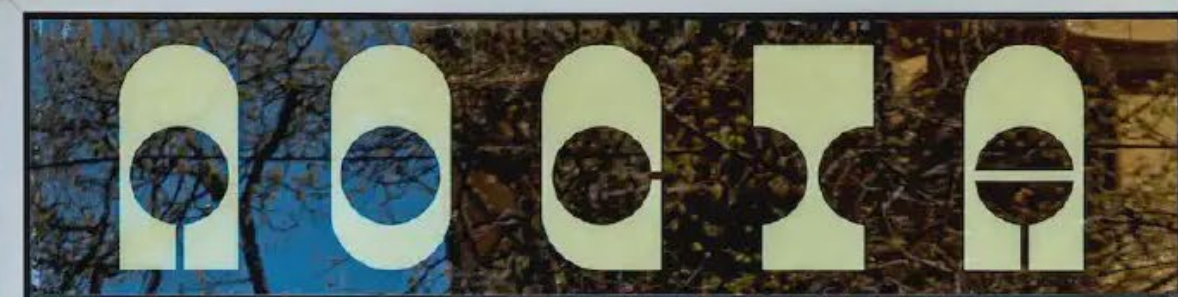
“Postcards and Contraband” has its inception in investigation of a professional yet eerily personal work archive of the Bulgarian Customs Agency, Directorate for Combating Drug Trafficking from 1975-1985. The service notes, photographs, negatives, summaries and reports found mark the routines of inspection and regulation of transit that the Customs Agency work undertakes, but also the diplomatic image the Customs Agency had to maintain in the face of international community.

The leading suspicion here is that the found archives give only a partial insight into the organized “hidden transit” - a term behind which the communist government of the People’s Republic of Bulgaria concealed the smuggling trade carried out by the State Security through commercial enterprises and organizations. These traces are fragments of a wide-ranging system of customs regulations, trade routes, economic interests, international agreements, and geopolitical particularities.



Top left: Archive discovered by Aaron Roth during a routine visit to an antique dealer in Sofias the Woman’s Market.

The archive features personal and work-related photographs by agent of the Bulgarian Customs Agency, as well as numerous postcards, documents pertaining to legal and illegal trade, and various items of paraphernalia.



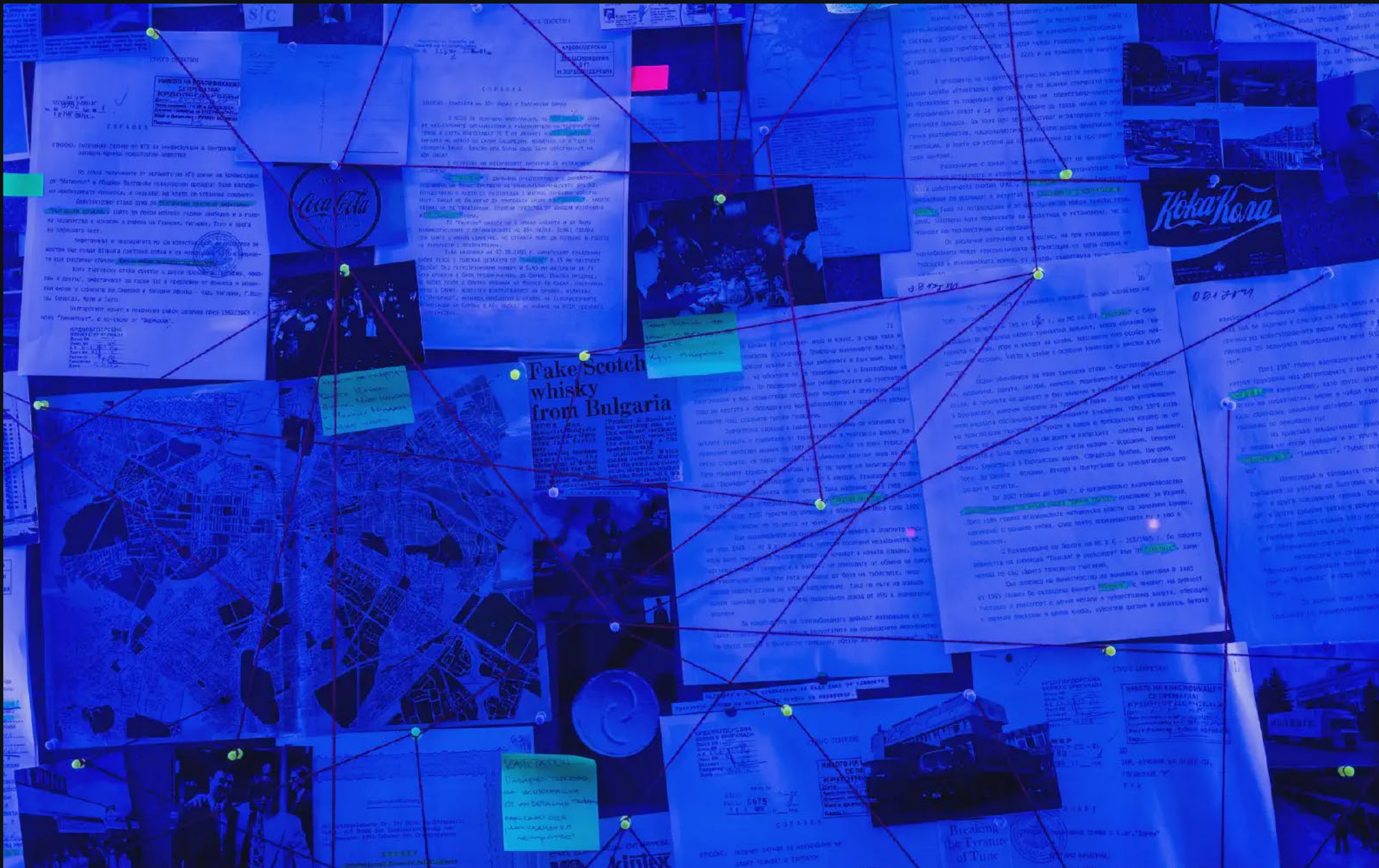
“The First Ten” takes the form of a large conspiracy map, recalling the cinematic trope of the detective evidence board. Its visual language is constructed from authentic archival materials: declassified documents from the Bulgarian State Security, newspaper headlines, press clippings, and photographs of notorious mafia assassinations from the early years of Bulgaria’s transition to democracy.

Red threads connect the names of former and still-active politicians, dead and living mafia figures, famous 1990s nightclubs, industrial facilities, and key historical events. The resulting network traces the hidden affiliations and informal power structures that shaped the post-socialist transition.

Drawing on investigative journalism, archival research, and documents from the People’s Republic of Bulgaria Customs Agency, the work reconstructs fragments of the illegal Captagon trade and the continued influence of former State Security networks.

The installation presents the Bulgarian transition as a landscape of partial evidence, where archival fragments, rumours, and historical trauma intertwine, producing a collective memory that oscillates between investigation and paranoia.

Custom built wood panel,
Newspaper clippings, printed paper, photo-
graphs, sticky notes, red thread on cork board
ultraviolet led lighting
yellow flurencet marker
150x200 cm / 60x78 in.



Left:

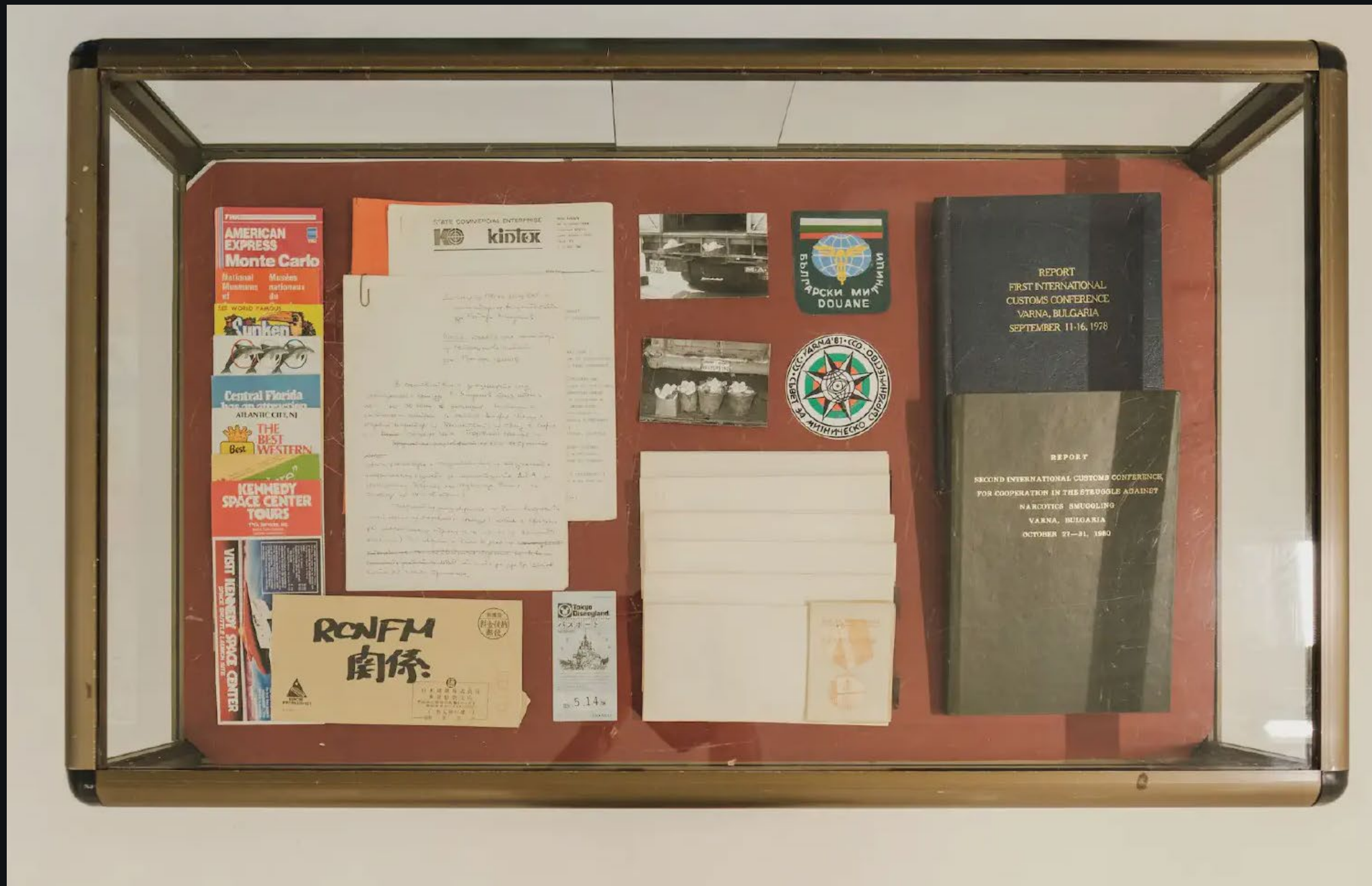
Detailed night view of
“The First Ten”

The name of the artwork refers to both the first ten years of the bugarian transition to democracy, as well as a common saying, referring to a persons bad behaviours stemming from a lack of parenting in the first ten years of ones life.

Custom built wood panel,
Newspaper clippings,
printed paper, photographs,
sticky notes, red thread on cork
board, ultraviolet led lighting
yellow flurencent marker

Timer for night and day view

150x200 cm / 60x78 in.



Top Left:

View of found archive featuring two reports of international customs conferences, documents pertaining to notorious arms dealer Kintex, photographs of seized drugs (probably hashish), ticket to Tokyo Disneyland and various post cards and tourists guides.

Archival display case
100x150x120 cm. / 39x59x47 in.

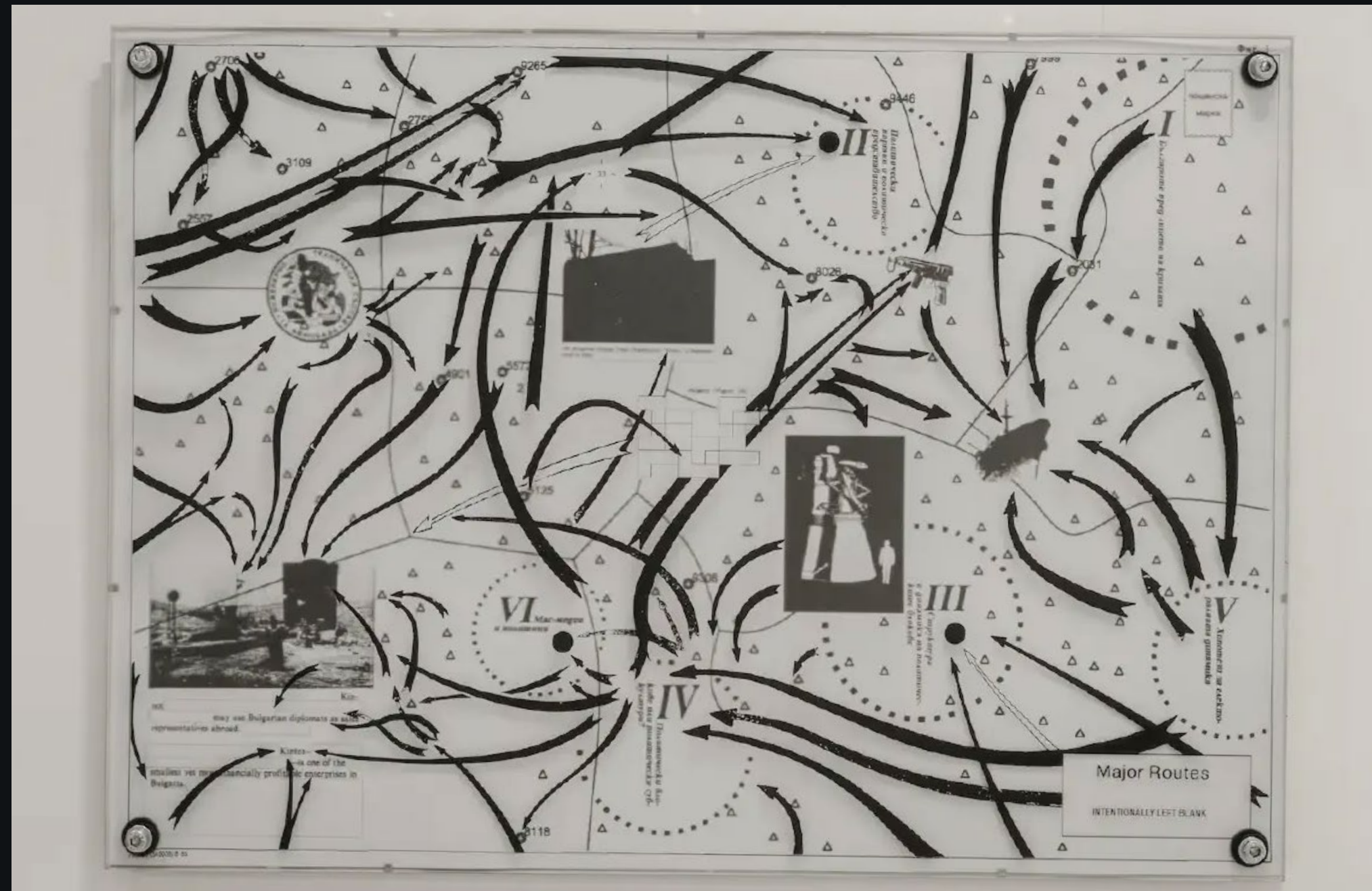
Bottom Left:

Video installation featuring found documents as well as commentary from Raina Markova's book Control.

Three-channel Video Installation
played on synchronised DVD players and CRT TV's.
10:00 min.

[Full video work here](#)

[On the Trail of a Banal Insight](#)
talk accompanying the Sofia showing, featuring the artist and investigative journalist and writer Raina Markova.



Top Right:

Print on shaped risograph paper, framed in a custom frosted-glass screen with an additional print.
70x50 cm.
(28x20 in.)

The map is assembled from declassified CIA documents on global drug trafficking routes, a 1989 issue of Democracy magazine, and archival materials related to the Kintex arms trade.

Bottom Right:

Detail: Bulgarian Aviation patch featuring Sonic the Hedgehog.

The leading suspicion here is that the found archives give only a partial insight into the organized “hidden transit” a term behind which the communist government of the People’s Republic of Bulgaria concealed the smuggling trade carried out by the State Security through commercial enterprises and organizations. These traces are fragments of a wide-ranging system of customs regulations, trade routes, economic interests, international agreements, and geopolitical particularities. Accompanying official documents, including transcripts of diplomatic encounters, attestations, in-state reports, and international addresses, underscore the hidden nature of the archive. These documents are intended for internal circulation within government departments whose primary business is to detect smuggling and maintain state-regulated ‘hidden transit’. This double diplomacy of concealment is also imprinted in the technique of documenting smuggling activities. They simultaneously expose the hidden cargo, but in other cases facilitate its passage. Thus, the official documents and photographs found on the periphery of the state archive and overlooked by the institutions of memory exist as a negative image of history.

Left:
Black Leather couch, marble coffee table,
Persian rug, recalling the rooms where
custom agents work and in the period of
transition often took bribes in the form of
Chivas Regal whiskey.

The exhibition was sponsored 20 bottles
of said whiskey by Pernod Ricard.

Top Right:
Rear Left (2024)
Nikola Stoyanov and Aaron Roth

Opel Kadett (1984-1991)
door modified for smuggling
drug packests

Unitield (2023) - Aaron Roth
oil on canvas and metal frame
150x340 cm. / 59x134 inch.

Bottom Right:
Photographs from found archives
customs training film reels.



Varna Showing

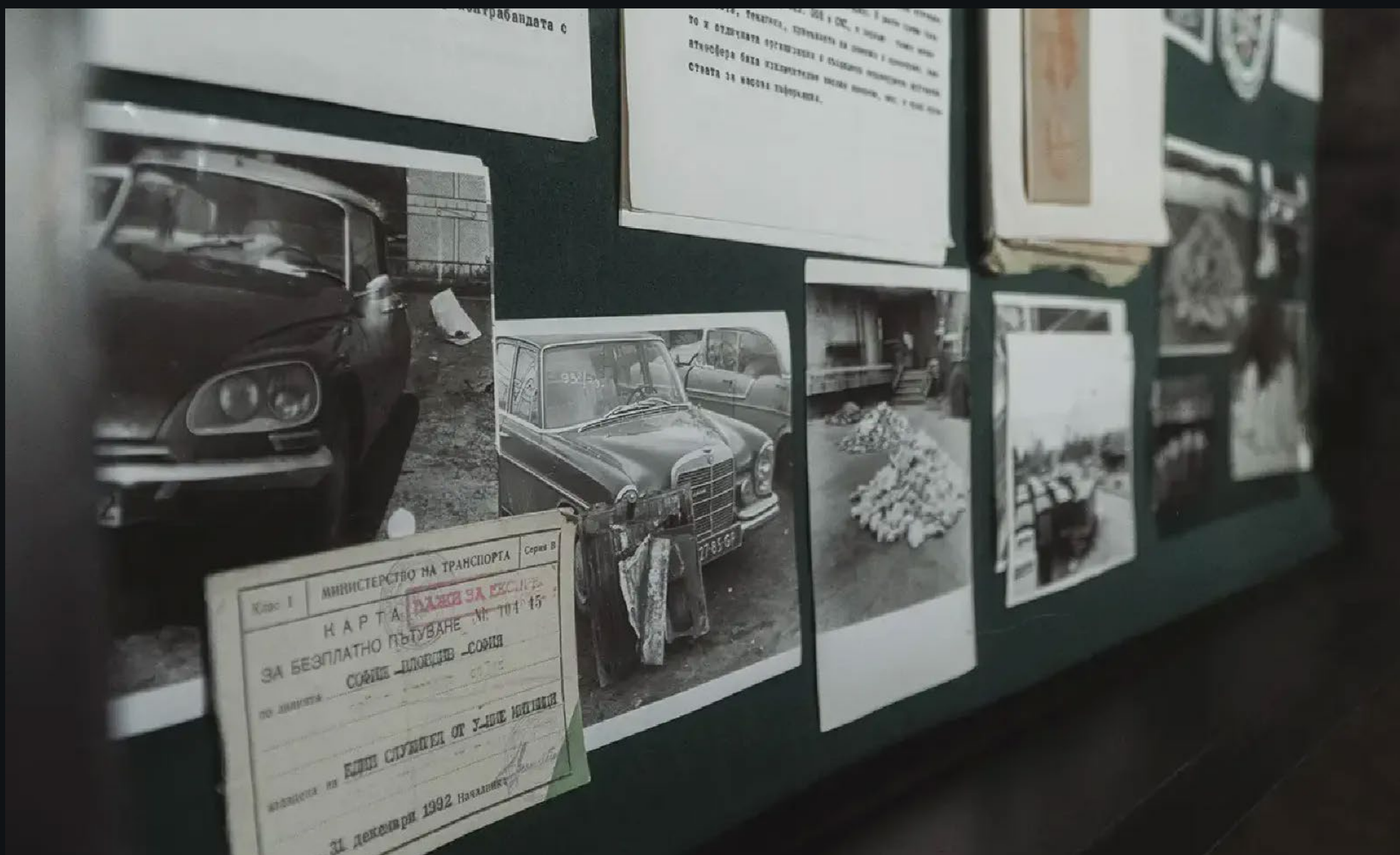
Re:Bonkers Varna
07.09- 21.09.2023



Two-Channel Video
Intallation played on
synchronosed DVD
playes and CRT TV's.
10:00 min.

Installation voice per-
formed by actress
Emilia Toneva.

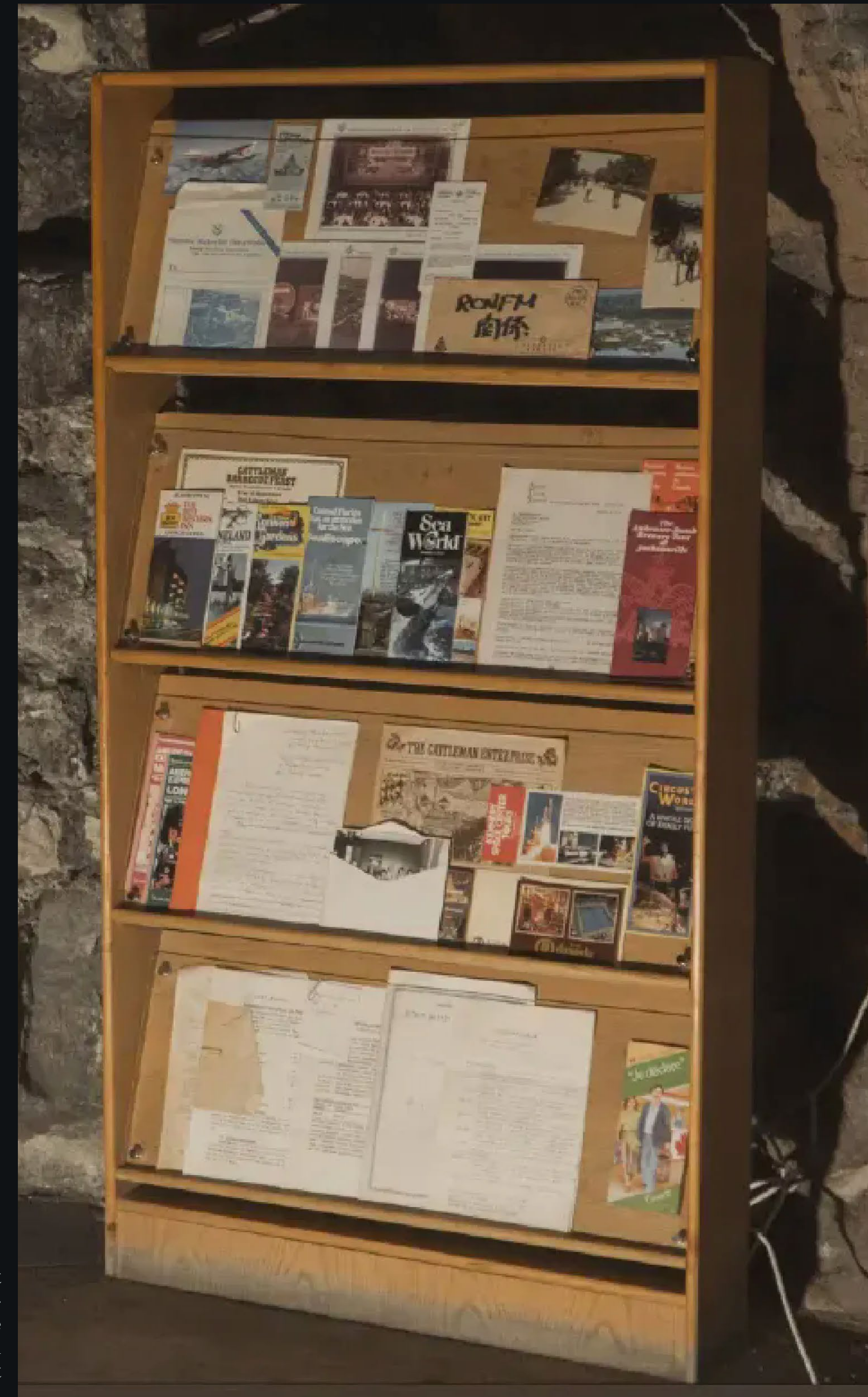
[Full video work here ↗](#)

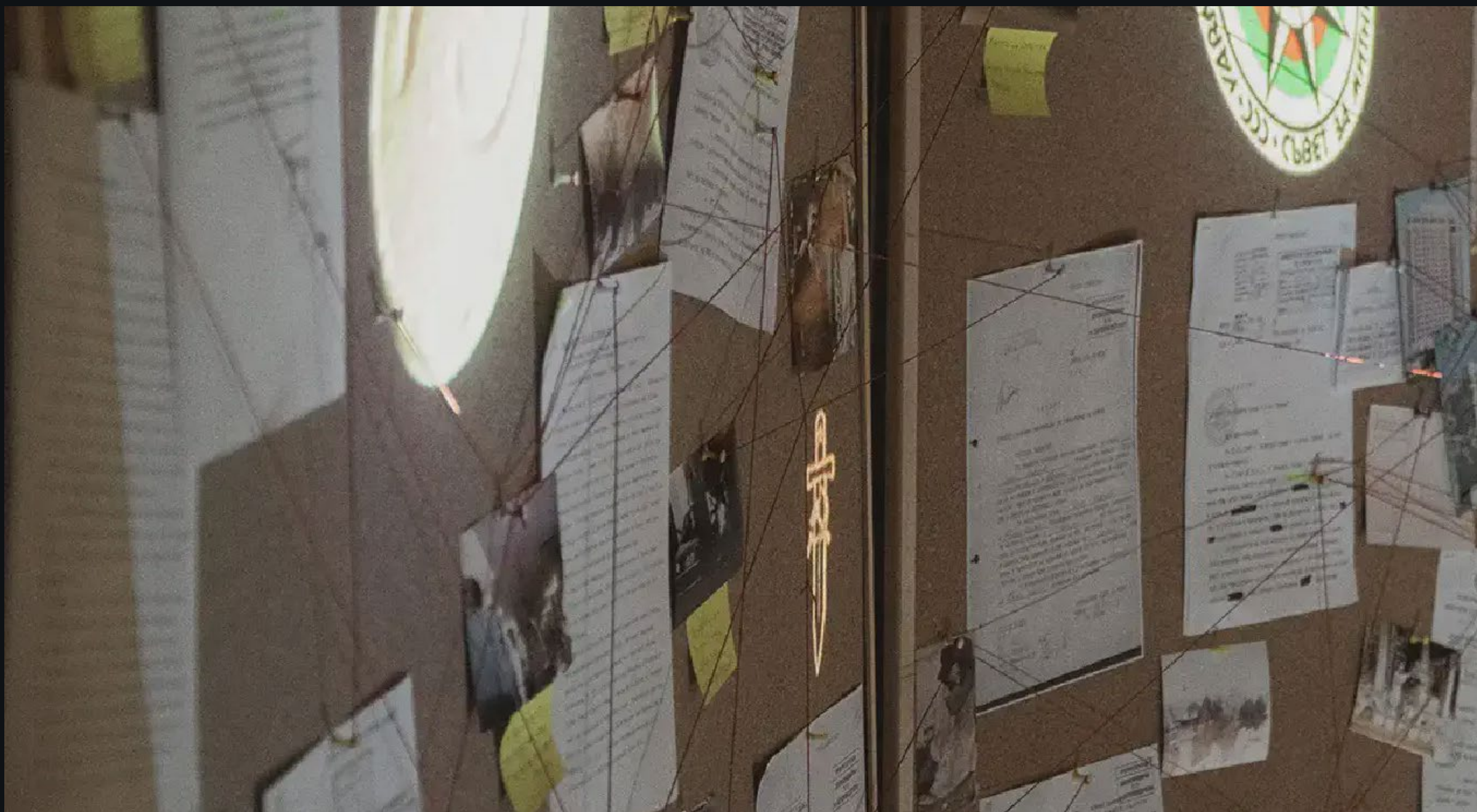


Documents depicting
smuggling, as well as
seized motor
vehicles in the
border crossing
Captain Andreevo.

Archival
display case

Postcards, tourist
guides, and photo-
graphs found in the
archive presented on
an authentic tourist
bulletin board.





Early iteration of the “The First Ten” as shown in Varna.

Two 150×100 cm. (59x39 inch.) cork boards with various documents, photographs, and newspaper clippings connected by red string. Projection-mapped images.



Gallery view of the exhibition at Re:Bonkers, Varna.

Book↓

An accompanying book with reproductions of the archive, transcriptions of found documents and a text by curator Hristo Kaloyanov was published under the same name as the exhibition “Postcards and Contraband” (2023) ISBN: 978-619-92510-1-0

Graphic design for book and exhibitions by Zahari Dimitrov

Left:
Six spreads of the book.

Supporting Events↓

On the trail of a banal insight[↗] - Discussion to the exhibition “Postcards and Contraband” Charta Gallery , Sofia (BG)

Talk with the head of drug smuggling prevention in the Bulgarian Customs Agency at Re:Bonkers, Varna (BG)

Critique↓

The Grammar of Historical Images[↗]
Liuboslava Hristova
Critical essay, Sofia University Culture Center.

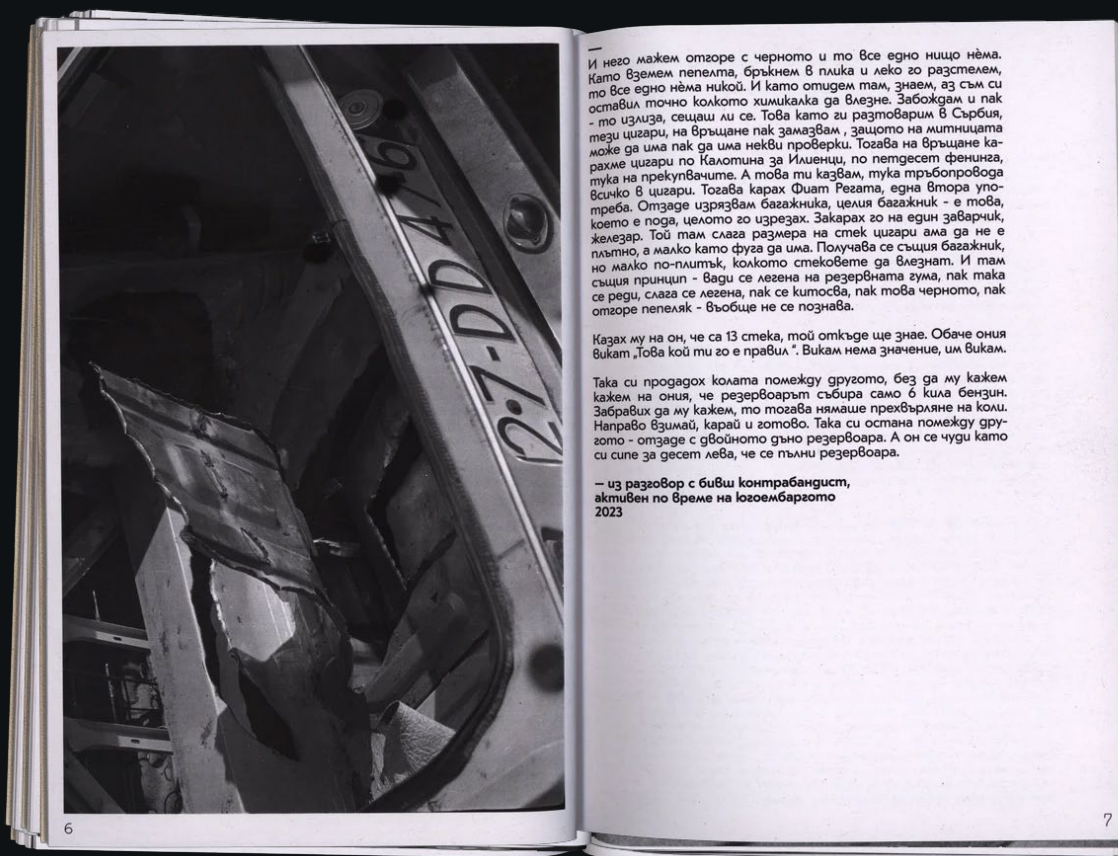
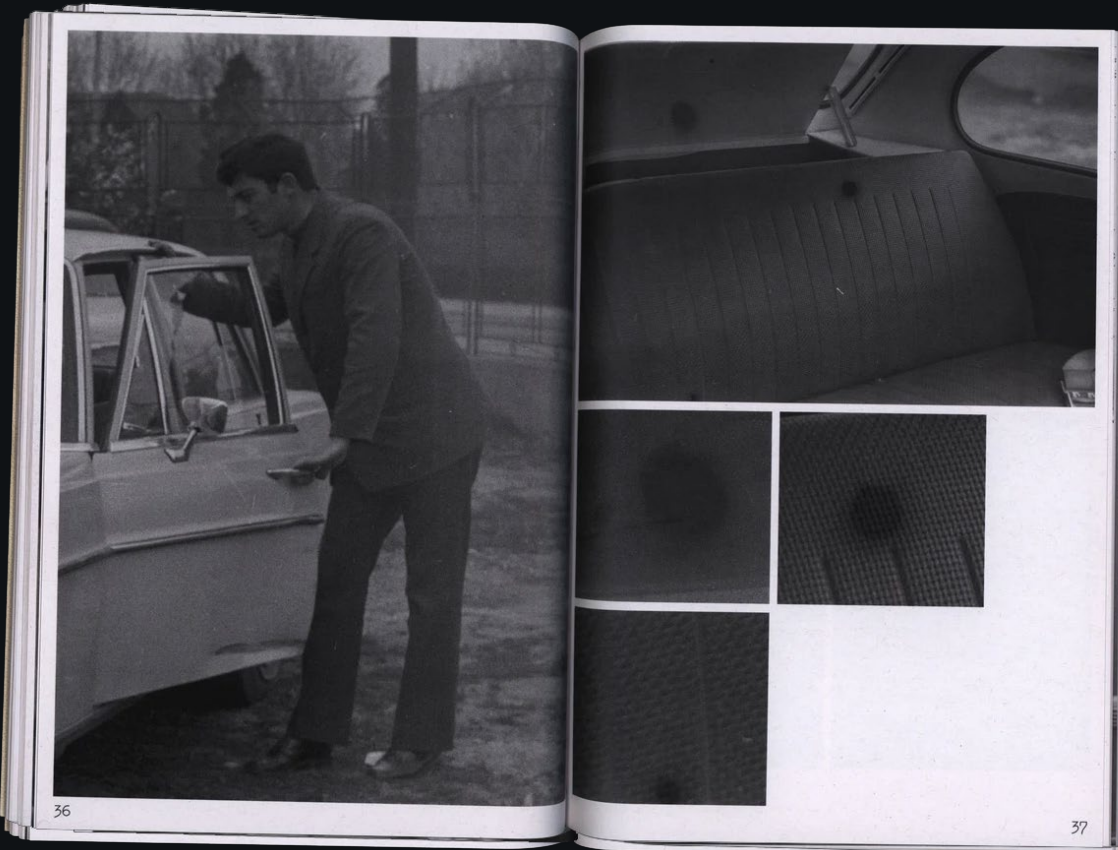
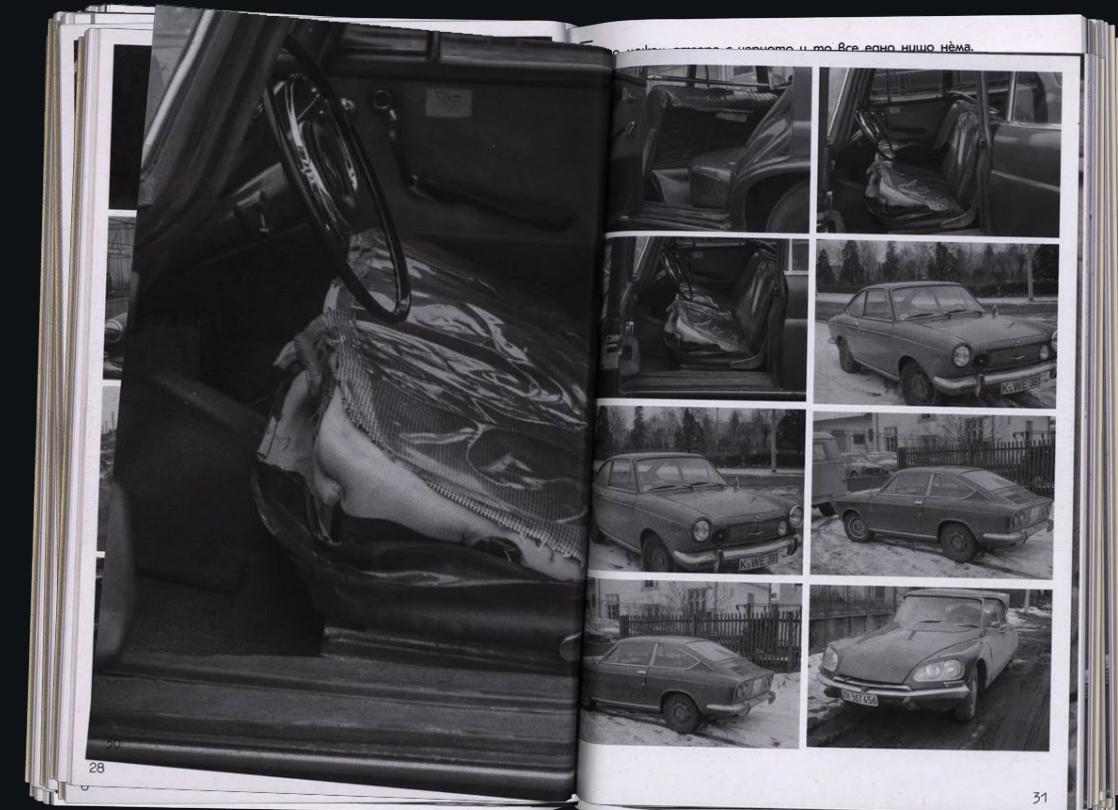
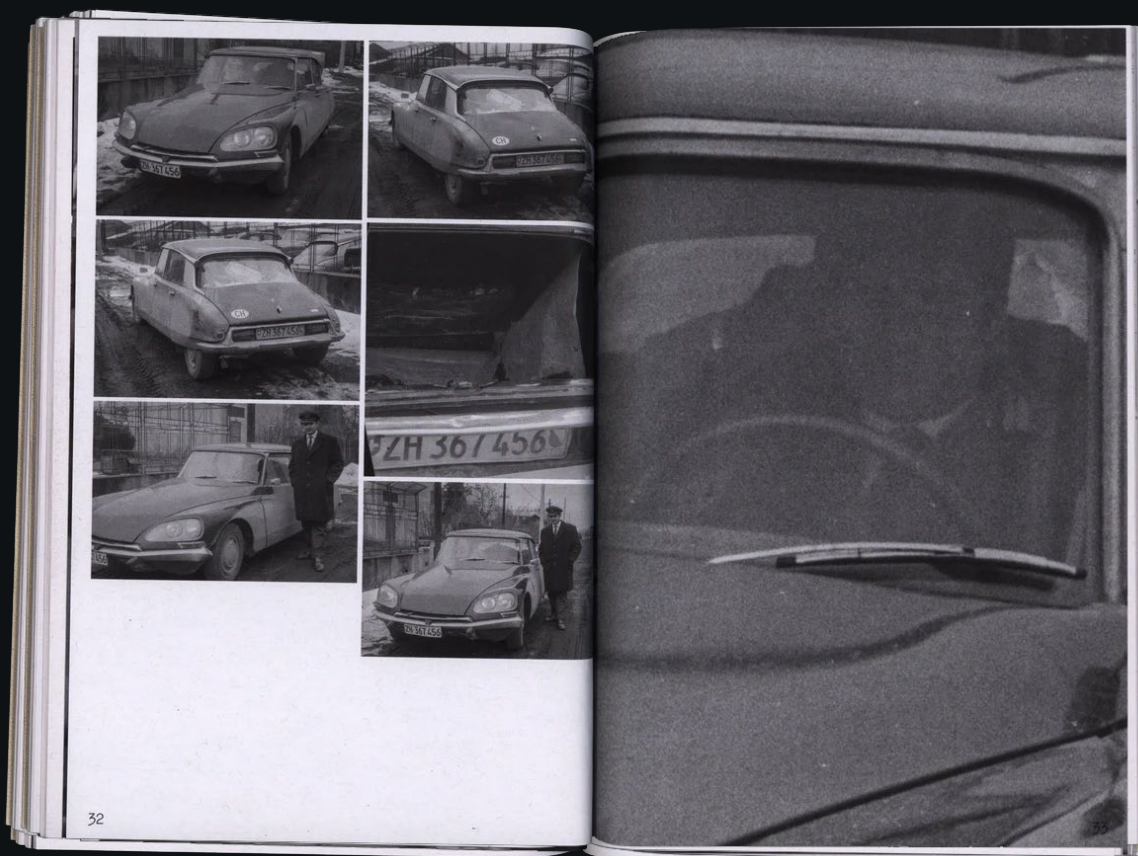
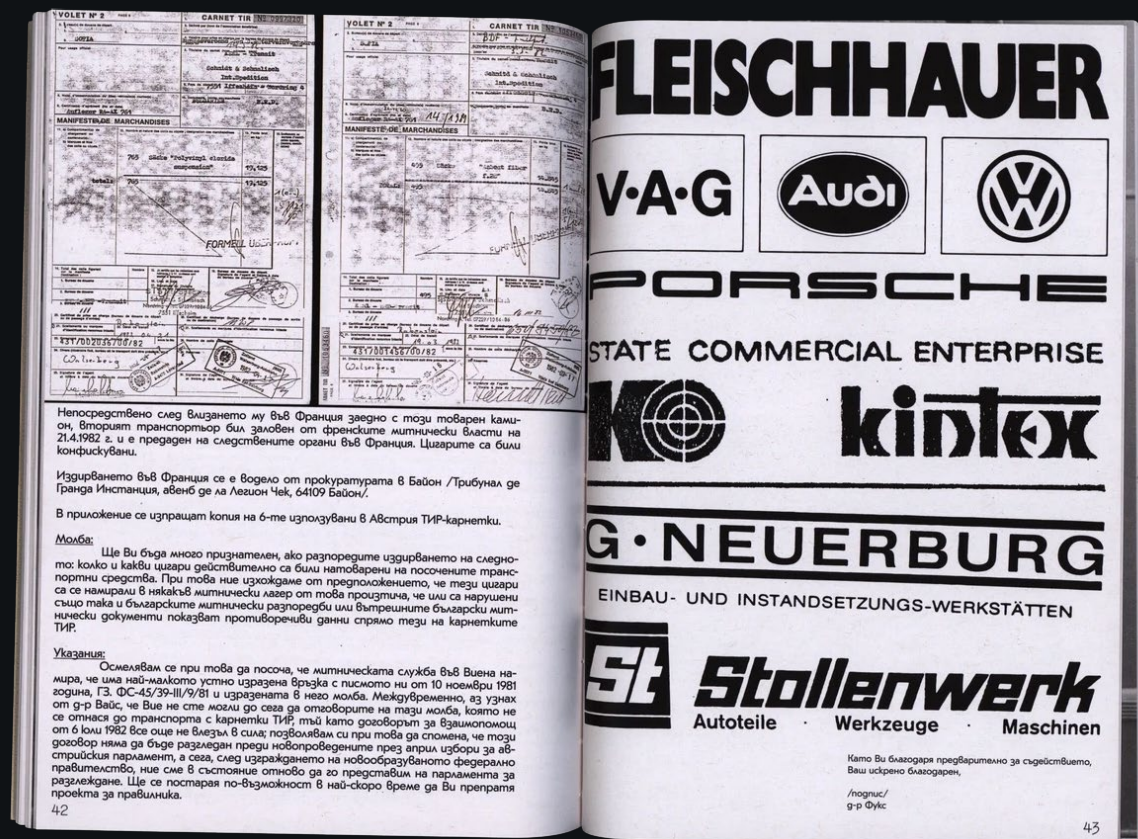
Contraband and the Offshore[↗]
Vera Mlechevska
Critical essay, Sofia University Culture Center.

Contraband, described as postcards[↗]
Review in Bulgarian Art Blog.

Press↓

Sofia:
Art Viewer[↗]
Bulgarian National Television[↗]
EuroNews TV[↗]
Bulgarian National Radio[↗]
Bulgaria Today[↗]
Programata[↗]
Radio Program Horizont[↗]

Varna:
Bulgarian Telegraph Agency[↗]
Bulgarian National Radio[↗]
Culture News[↗]
News Paper Utro[↗]



Nature Morte

Goethe-Institut (Sofia, BG)

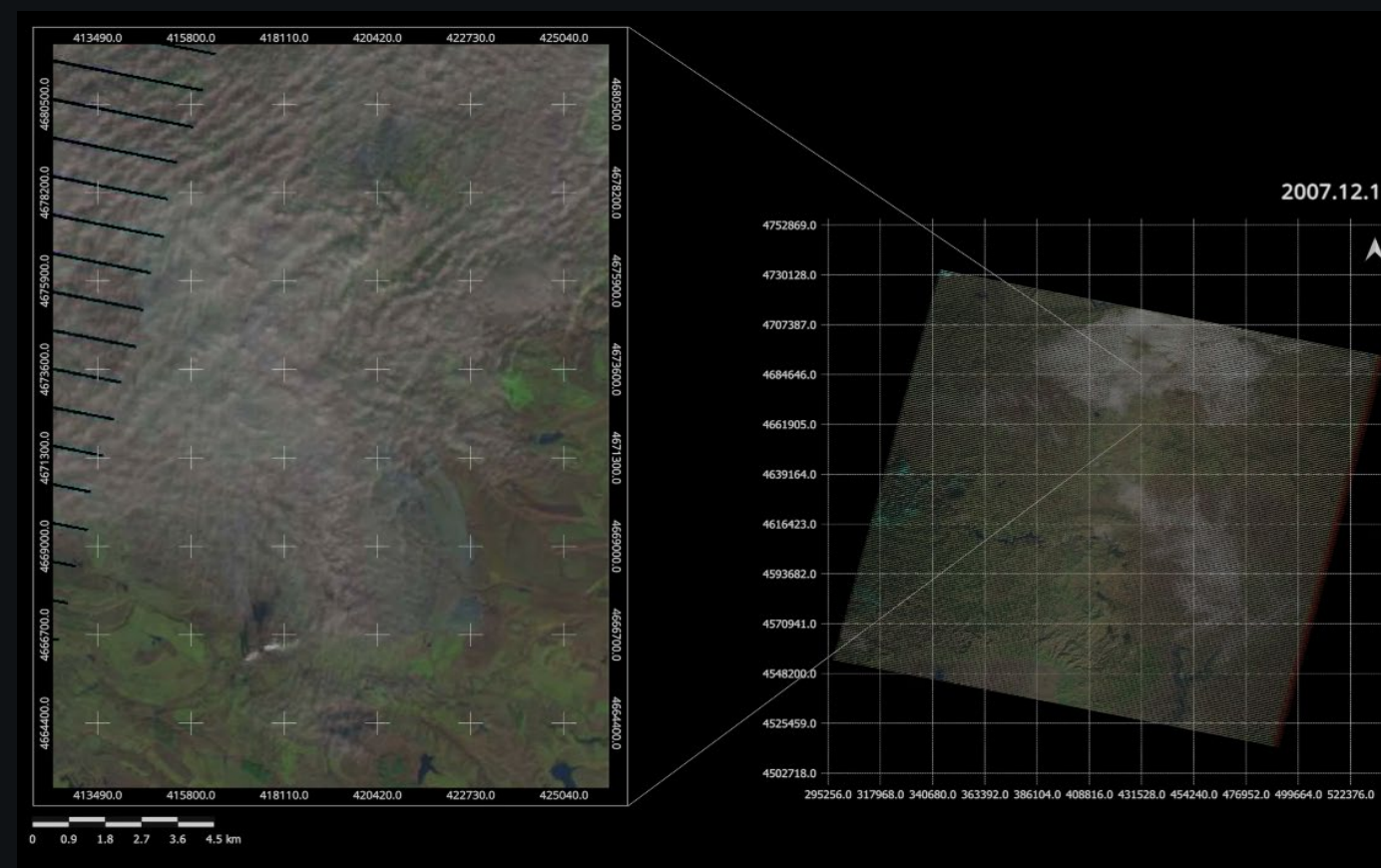
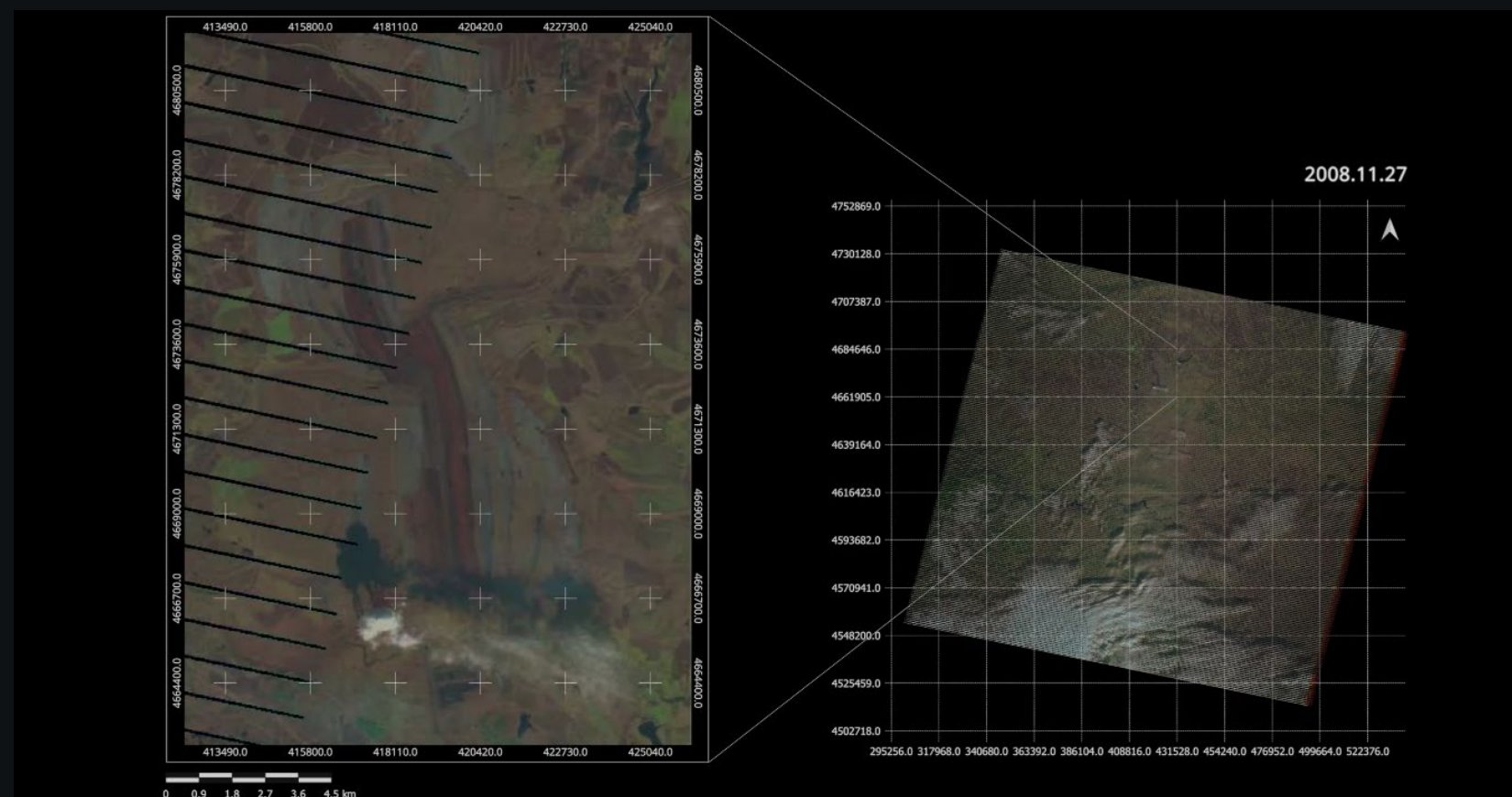
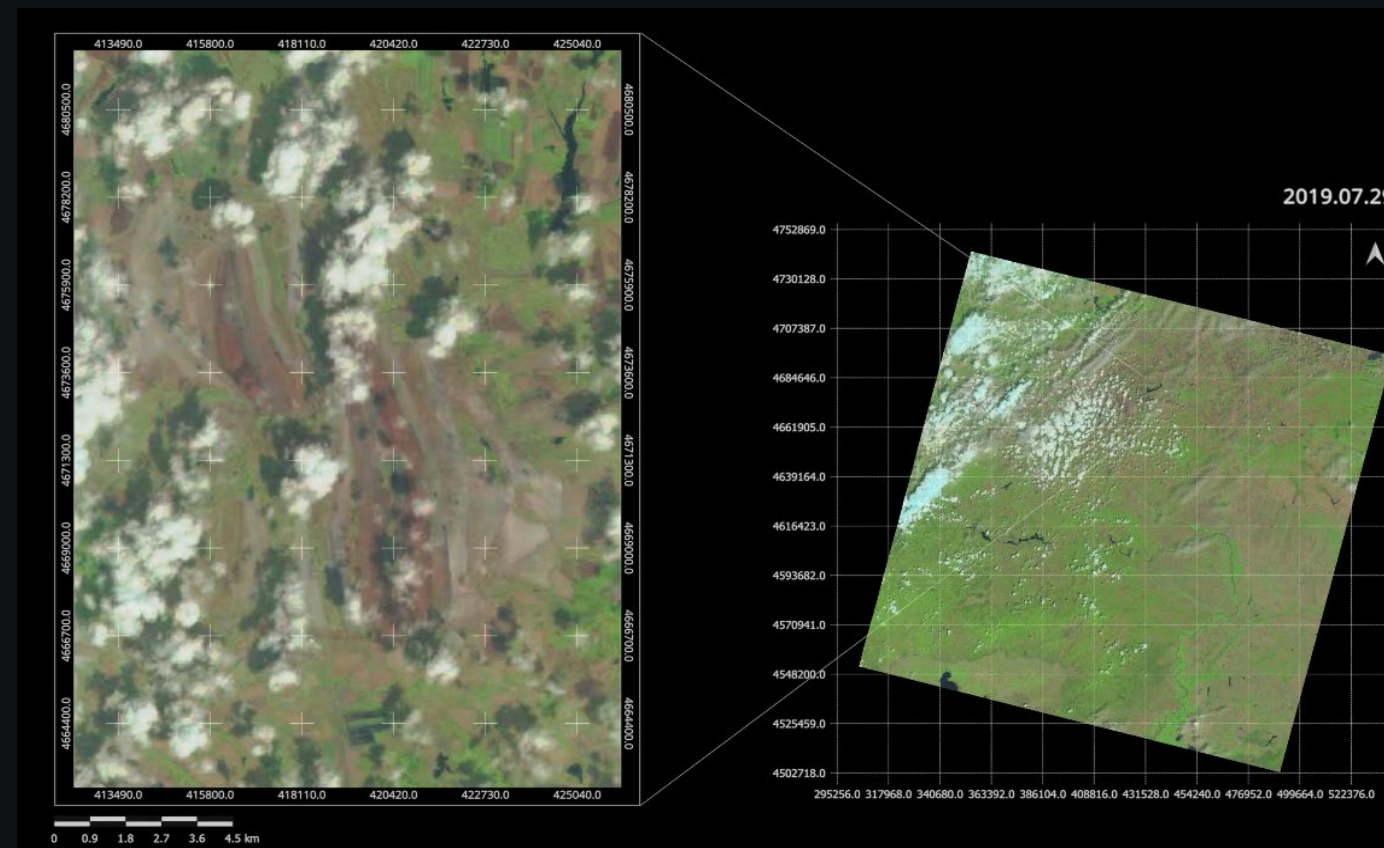
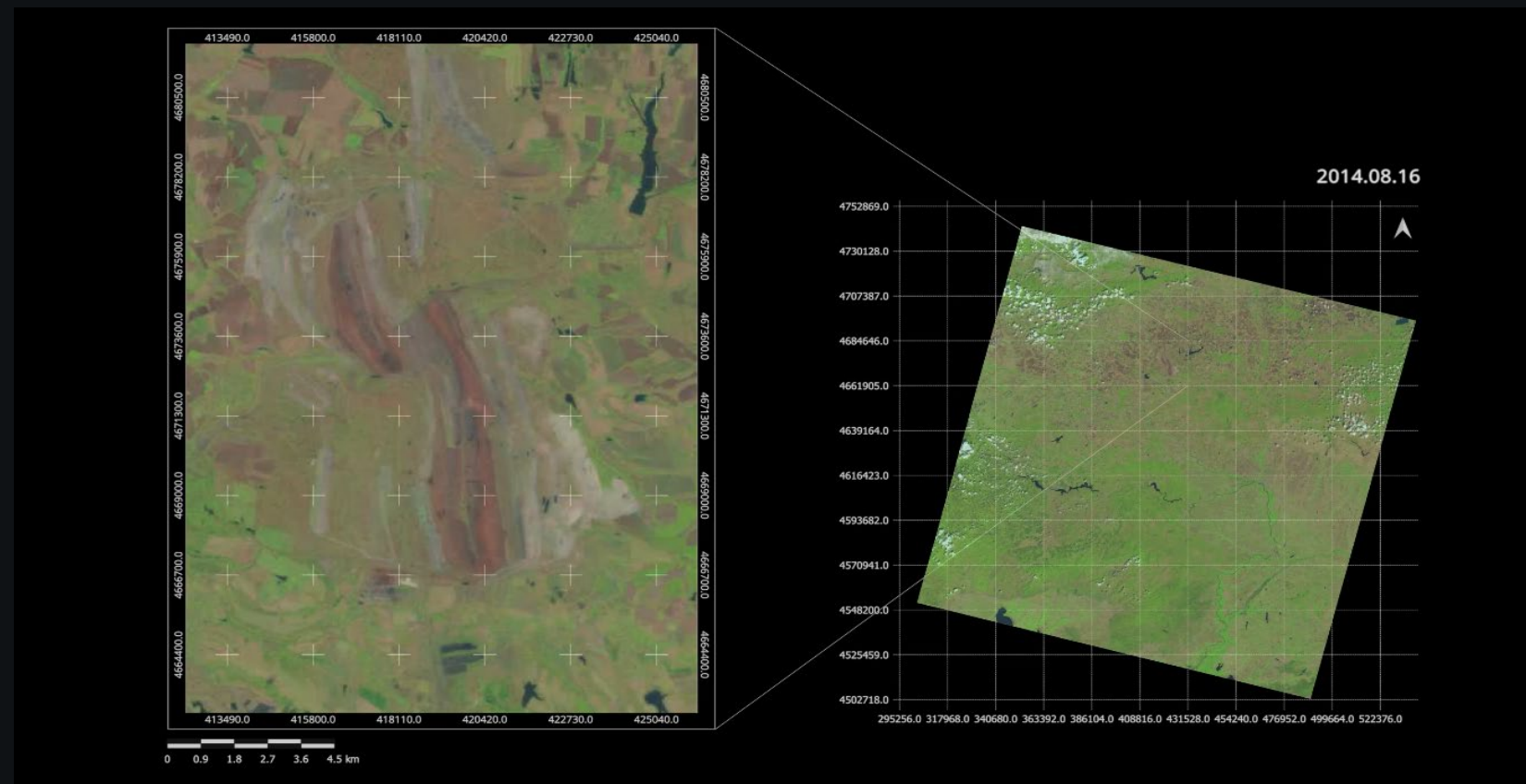
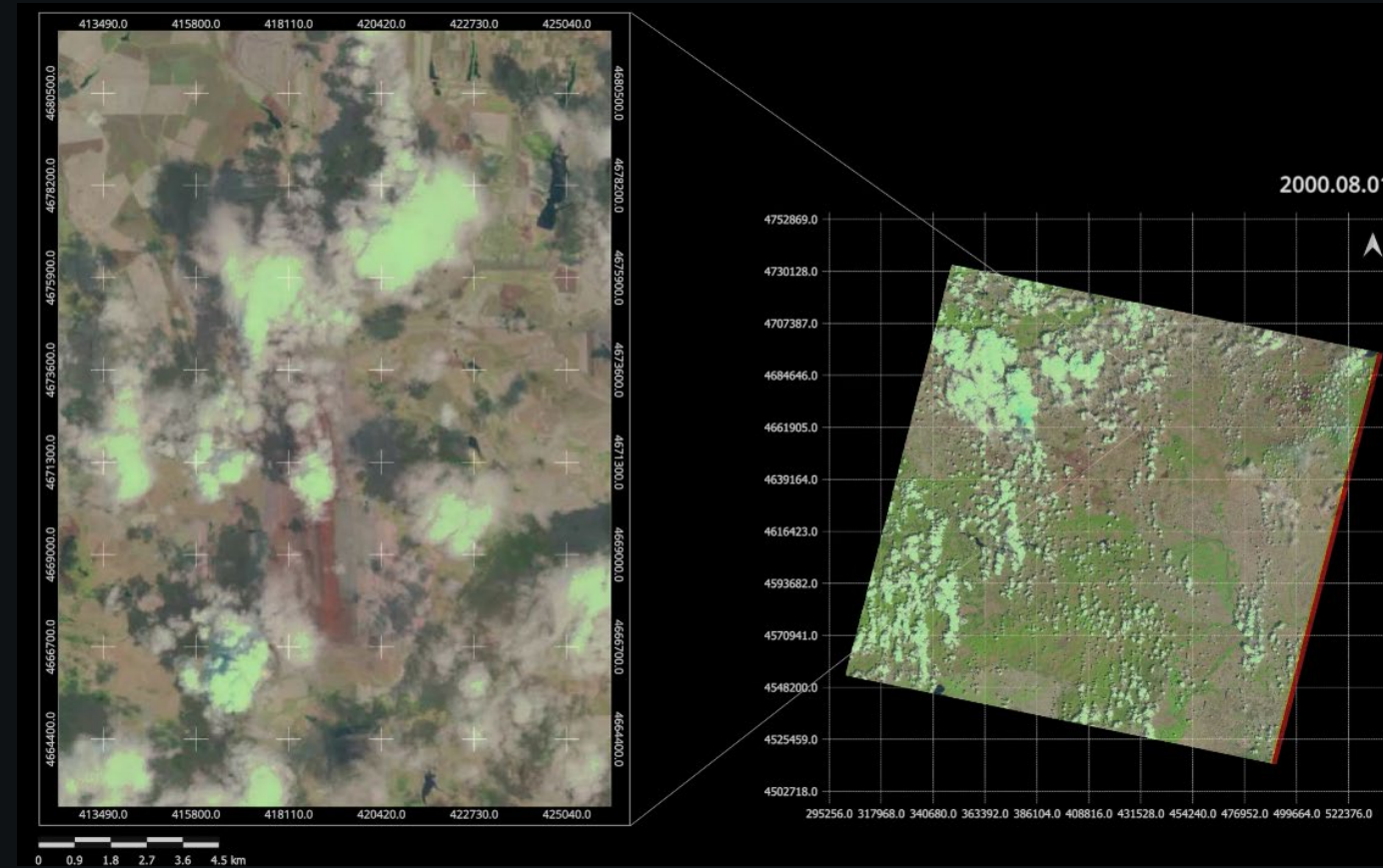
22.06-30.07.2023

LED TV 50x70cm. / 20x28 inch.
Video installation, 21:30 min.

[Link to whole video](#)

Stills from the video installation were presented on an LED television screen welcoming visitors to the exhibition and tracing over 40 years of the mine’s evolution.

The video was created using publicly available data from Landsat and the European Space Agency, processed with open-source geospatial software and custom Python scripts.



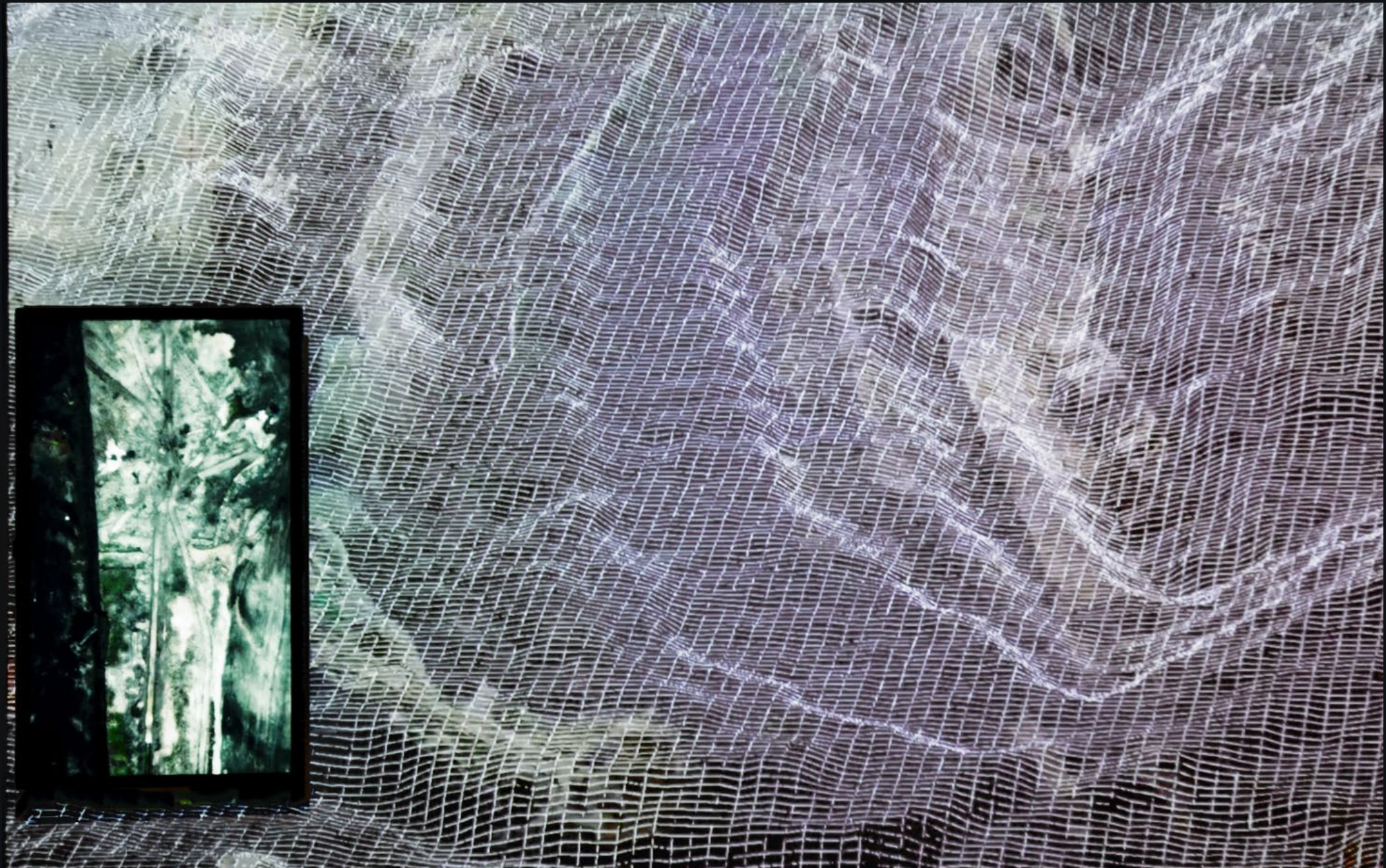
Nature Morte

curated by Hristo Kaloyanov

Nature Morte is a multimedia project that plants a philosophical question firmly in the ground, focusing on a highly restricted piece of national critical infrastructure. The project investigates the peninsula’s largest coal mine through the concept of geo-trauma, drawing on the work of Sándor Ferenczi and Nick Land. Seeking alternative approaches to accessing and visualising the excavation, the work uses open satellite data, geological surveys, and measurement records to reconstruct the digital topography of the mine.

The resulting visuals can be described as operational images, extending the concept coined by filmmaker Harun Farocki to describe “images that do not represent an object but are part of an operation.” Here, the operation unfolds as a philosophy on the ground, tracing the mining process itself alongside the administrative structures that accompany it, while proposing a displacement of the anthropocentric perspective.

This operational gaze, no longer tied to the lens of the kino-eye, provides precise coordinates of the event: it locates catastrophe and marks its traces on the visible surface. Against the vast timescale of geological formation—where layers accumulate over millions of years mining introduces abrupt ruptures. Through excavation, the earth’s strata are opened, revealing traces of long-submerged worlds within the critical infrastructure of the Maritsa-Iztok mines.



Top Right:
LED TV 50x70cm. / 20x28 inch.
Video installation 21:30 min.

[Link to whole video ↗](#)

Top Left:
LED TV 70x50cm. / 20x28 inch.
Projection on wall

[Link to whole video ↗](#)

Bottom Right:
7 inch CRT TV with DVD
Video installation 21:30 min.
multi-spectral satellite imagery



Right:
3D Printed backlit
topological map
70x50cm / 28x20 inch.

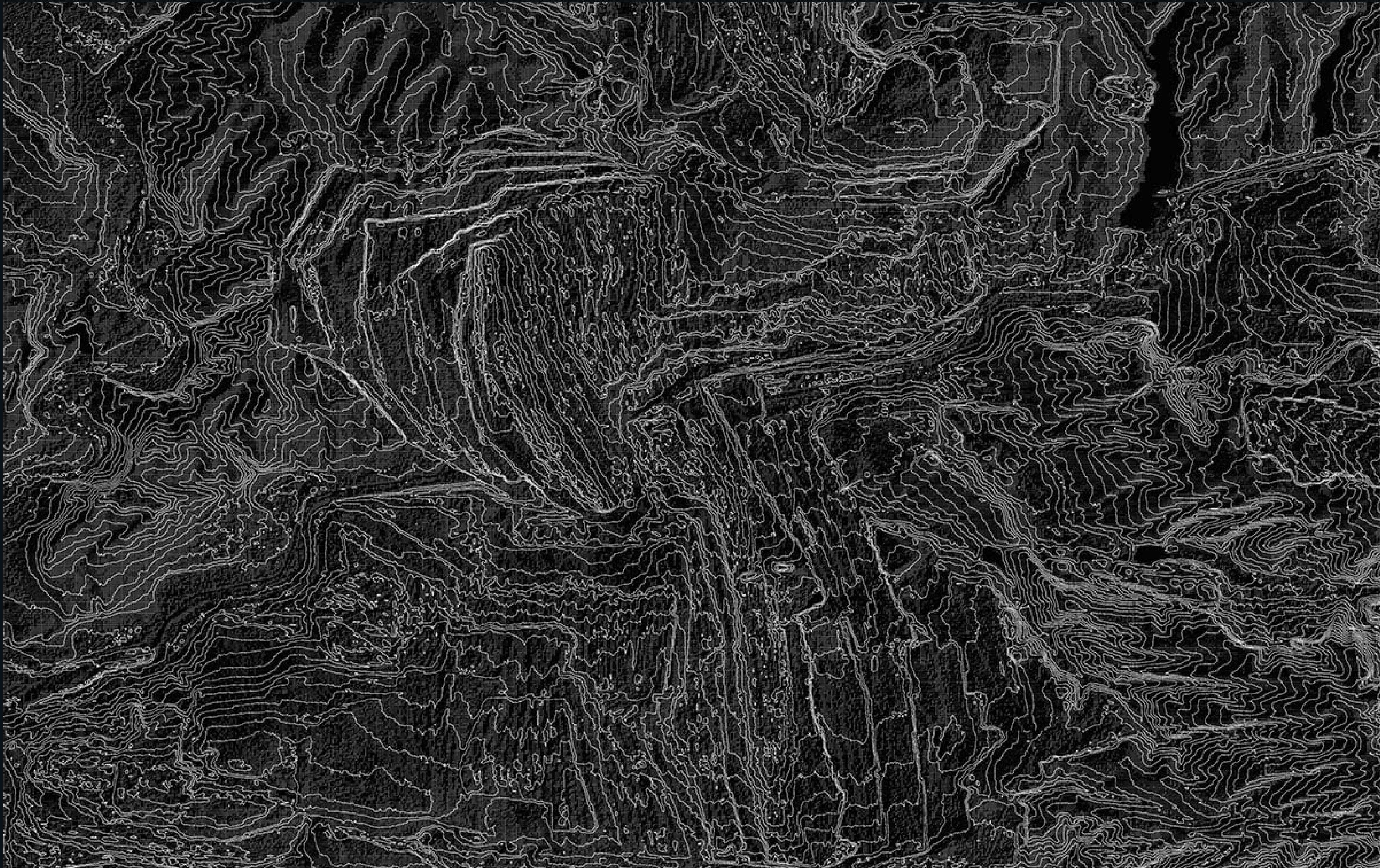


Photoprint
70x50cm / 28x20 inch.



Photoprint
100x50cm / 39x12 inch.





Left:

**Topological map of mine
region.**

**Digital collage of geospatial
data retrieved from European
Geological Data Infrastruc-
ture (EGDI), EuroGeoSurveys.**

**Print of glass
70x50 cm. / 20x28 inch.
black paper backing**



A book featuring writing by both the curator and the artist was produced for the exhibition. It includes on-site photography, archival materials from the Stara Zagora and Sofia archives, and essays addressing Harun Farocki's concept of the operative image as well as the notion of geo-trauma in the work of Sándor Ferenczi, Sigmund Freud, and Nick Land. Graphic design by Elena Chergilanova. ISBN: 978-619-92510-0-3

Supporting Events↓

As part of the exhibition “to slip, to slide, to glitch” ↗
03.06-12.07.24 Galerie Futura, Berlin (DE)

Screening of NATURE MORTE at VideoArt Garden ↗
14-17.09.23, Timisoara (RO)

Critique↓

Towards a Geosophy of the Catastrophe↗
Philip Stoilov
Critical essay published by Sofia University Culture Center.

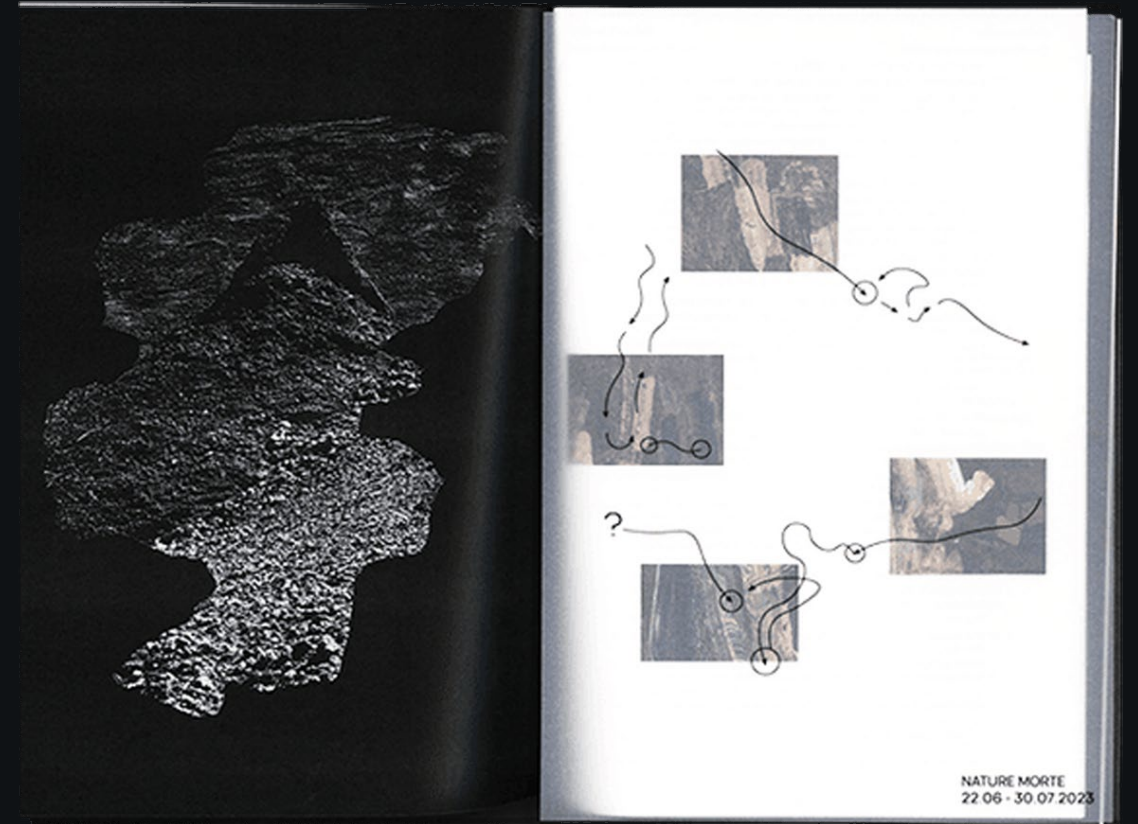
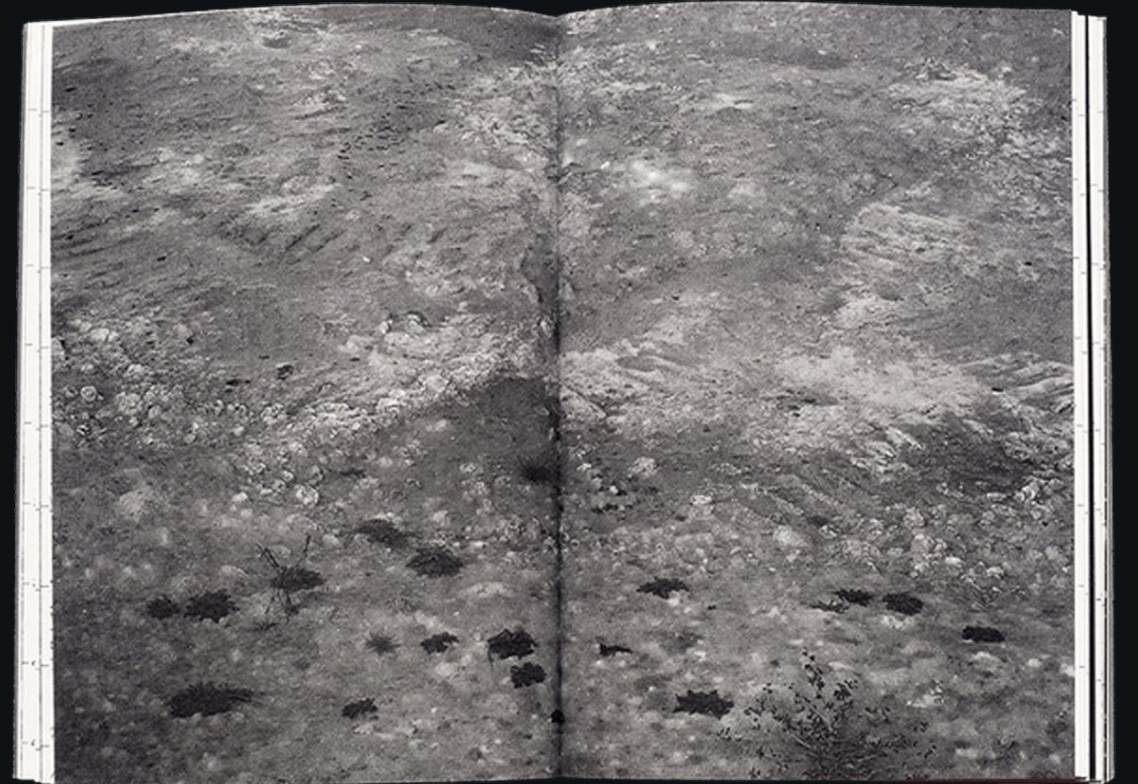
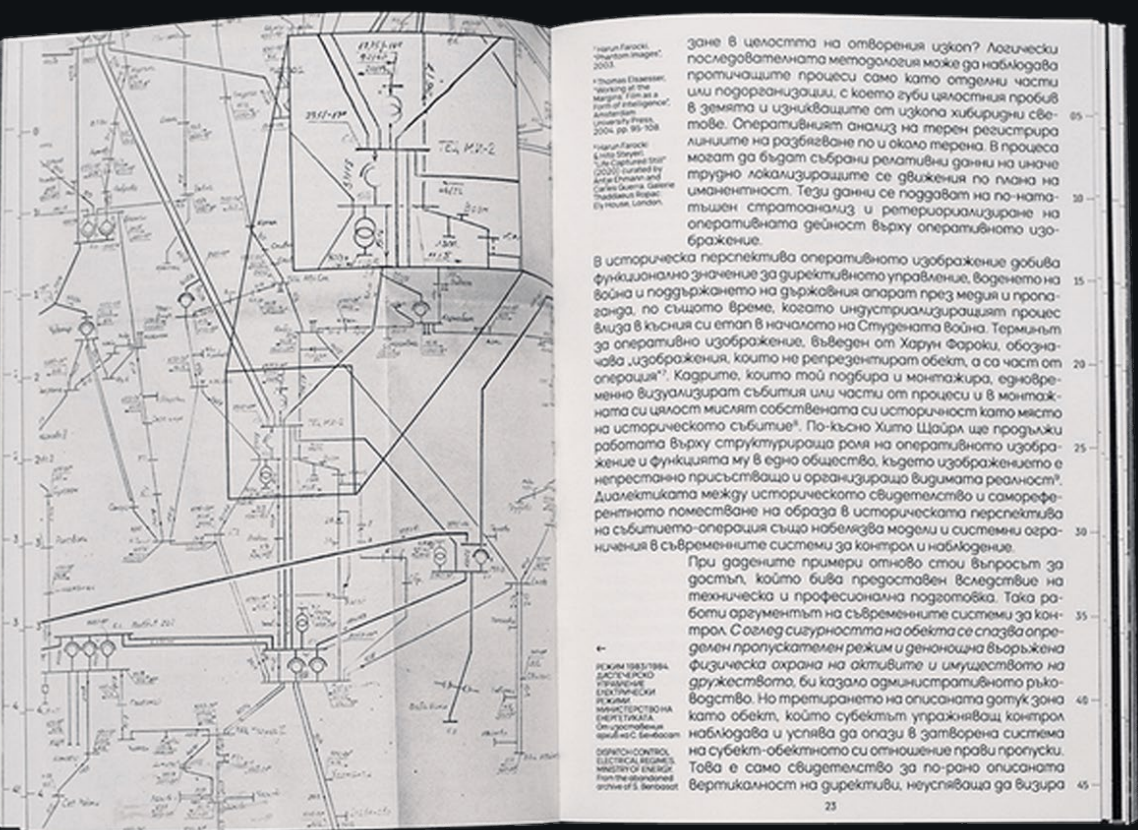
Kintsugi. Dealing with the trauma in the summer of 2023↗
Boyana Djikova
Review in the series “Critique × 3 | June 2023”.

Observing the Geotraumatic Lines of Flight On Terrain↗
Hristo Kaloyanov
Conference report for “Culture, Infrastructure, Mobility”.

Press↓

Bulgarian National Television↗
Bulgarian National Radio ↗
Bloomberg TV↗
Darik Radio↗
Bulgarian Telegraph Agency↗
Impressio↗
Boy Scout Magazine↗
Artnews Cafe↗

Photograph of excavation machine feature in book.

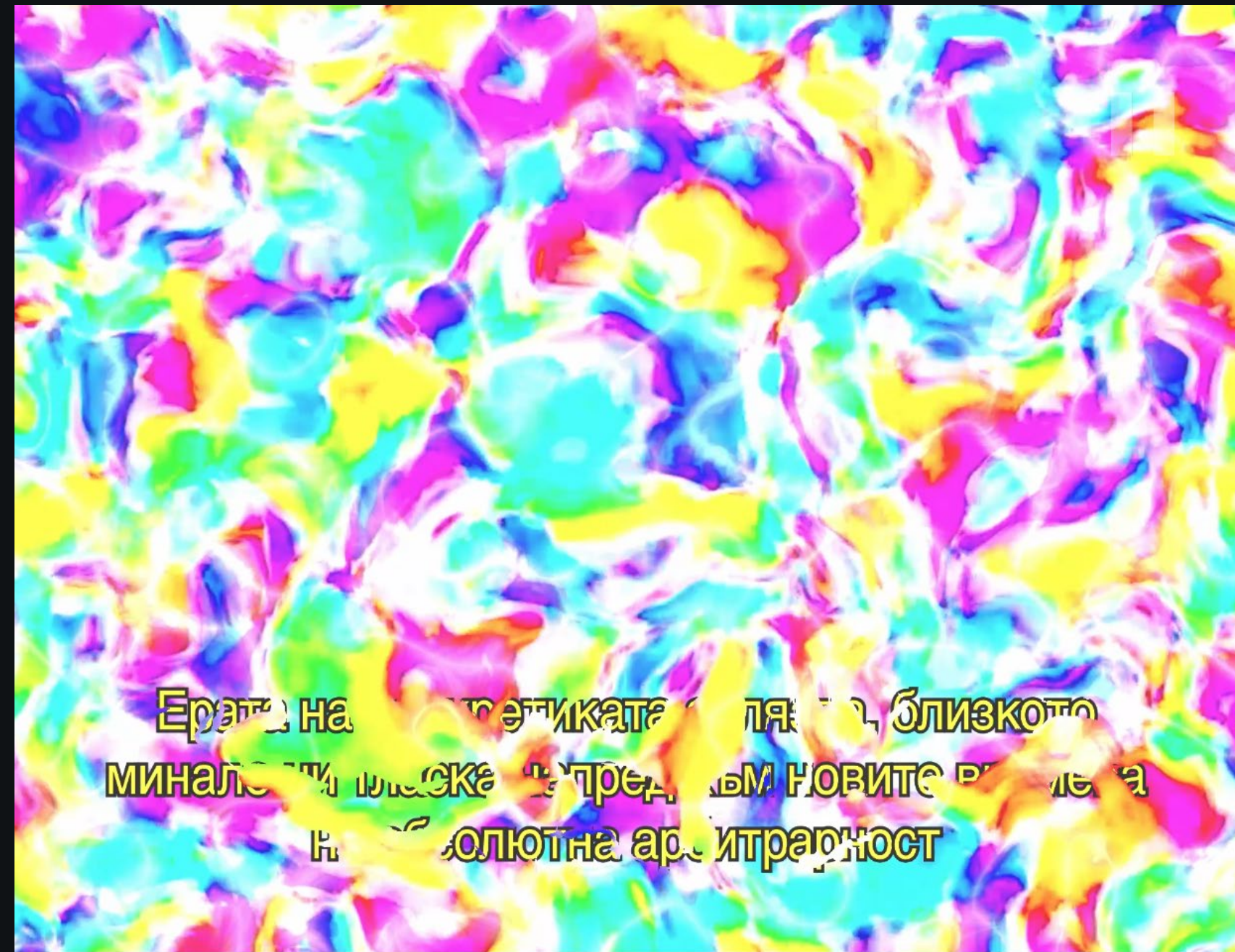


Page spreads of the book

Latent Space

Doza Gallery (Sofia, BG)

08.09-21.09.2022



Latent Space

curated by Hristo Kaloyanov

Latent space is where the gaze of artificial intelligence alone draws the picturesque horizon, delving into the hidden rooms of secret research centers, intelligence organizations, and classified databases. An imagined space that the machine illuminates, exposing the postmodern subject's built-in subversiveness of aesthetic experience in its internal mechanics, referentiality, and element of incompleteness. The so-called noise in communication theory is a recognized information field that does not lend itself to systematization. Instead, the algorithm builds faces, machines, corridors, and cloud spaces in their procedural incompleteness. The recent paranoia of unsubstantiated fact has become the factual divergence from a reference matrix.

More than a hallucination and less than reality. In the latent space, nothing is new, like for the absolute genius of the past, but only experienced as such in the schizophrenic grip of the clinically imprisoned. Like the traditional painting and the unique work of art, every tick, every deviation in artificial intelligence creates a forged reality - unique and complete in itself. The mechanics of this type of painting challenges the basic principle of the technique, where a function can be repeated under the same conditions. Instead, it becomes a virulent artistic gesture, exposing the deceptive charm of tradition in art and its reproduction.



Top Right:

Acrylic on canvas print,
90x62cm (35x24 inch.), private collection

Bottom Right:

Acrylic on canvas print,
90x62cm. (35x24 inch.), private collection

Top Middle:

Single Channel Video installation
on CRT TV, 03:35 mins.
[Link to whole video](#)

The exhibition was accompanied by a paper-long experimental written piece engaging Viktor Tausk's theory of the 'influencing machine,' revisiting his psychoanalytic account of persecutory delusion to examine how contemporary artificial intelligence systems reactivate the fantasy of externalized control, dislocated agency, and machinic mediation of thought.

Exhibition soundscape was crafted by Yan Lechev and Anton Shishkov and a 1 meter industrial fan, mimicking the atmosphere of clean rooms for chip productions.

[Link to whole text accompanying the exhibition](#)

Other Showings↓

[“The World After / Post-apocalyptic Notes”](#)
05.05.2023 | Sineu, Mallorca, SPAIN, curated by Neno Belchev,
in collaboration with Krassimir Terziev, Albena Baeva,
Konstantin Zlatev, Müge Yıldız

Accompanying Events↓

Discussion on the exhibition “Latent Space”, 20.09.2022
Doza Gallery, Sofia (BG)

Discussion on the exhibition “Latent Space”, 16.09.2022
ReBonkers, Varna (BG)



Left:

Still from video installation

Single channel video
installation projected on
gallery wall, 06:30 mins.

Sound design by Anton
Shishkov and Yan-Nikolai
Lechev.

[Link to whole video](#)↗



Latent Space is an exhibition that examines a recurring fear of technology — an “ultra-paranoia” that surfaces whenever machines begin to reshape human life. From Luddism to contemporary artificial intelligence, the project traces how technological change is often framed as a threat to autonomy, perception, and mental stability.

The accompanying text takes the form of a hybrid academic and fictional report. Drawing on the history of paranoid schizophrenia and technological anxiety, it blends research with speculation, reflecting the overlap between cultural fear and psychological projection.

The visual component consists of “fake paintings” created with early AI software, specifically Disco Diffusion. Unstable and technically limited, the system produced strange, dream-like images far from today’s polished AI outputs. Each image took close to three days to generate, emphasizing the experimental and imperfect nature of early machine image-making.



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Credits↓

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Mihail Novakov, Boyan Hristov,
Boris Vasilev, Zahari Dimitrov
and The Kopy Shop

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